



MISSING WEAPONS

Military intelligence joins arms theft probe

STATES » PAGE 5

DIMMING HOPES

Shifting focus from search to rehabilitation, says Nepal PM

WORLD » PAGE 14





NEW ROLE

IAF veteran first CEO of Ram Temple Trust

NEWS » PAGE 11

INDIA-CHINA TALKS

‘Early Harvest’ — larger but not necessarily safer

Hard questions remain over strategic costs

EDITORIAL » PAGE 6



GRITTY SHOW

Zverev overcomes Sonego's challenge

SPORT » PAGE 15

IN BRIEF

▼
Order CBI probe into exam ‘scam’: Jharkhand BJP

PATNA
A BJP delegation met the Jharkhand Chief Secretary on Wednesday and submitted a memorandum demanding a CBI inquiry into alleged irregularities in government recruitment exams conducted in the State. » **Page 3**

Ex-bureaucrat detained over online activity

NEW DELHI
Delhi Police Special Cell on Wednesday detained former bureaucrat Ashish Joshi and questioned him for several hours in connection with a case regarding his online activity before allowing him to go home. » **Page 3**

CSAT

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SC orders oversight of Bar Council’s policy decisions

Manan Kumar Mishra is only ‘pro tem’ chief of the lawyers’ body, says the top court; it directs the council to consult Attorney-General, Solicitor-General for all major decisions until fresh elections

Krishnadas Rajagopal
NEW DELHI

The Supreme Court on Wednesday made it clear that senior advocate Manan Kumar Mishra is serving only as the “pro tem” chairperson of the Bar Council of India (BCI) until fresh elections are held and directed the apex lawyers’ body to consult the Attorney-General and the Solicitor-General before taking any major policy decisions in the interim.

The hearing before a three-judge Bench headed by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant saw petitioners, including young lawyers, raise allegations, including the formation of the BCI Pearl First Trust in 2020 in which Mr. Mishra, also a BJP Rajya Sabha member,

Under scrutiny

The BCI chief, Manan Kumar Mishra, recently earned public ire with an attempt to ban the enrolment of NALSAR graduates

Allegations raised by petitioners in SC:

- Extension of the tenure of the BCI chairperson and vice-chairperson to five years
- Formation of the BCI Pearl First Trust in which Mr. Mishra and other BCI office-bearers are ‘permanent managing trustees’
- A tie-up between the Trust and the Goa government to set up a university on 56 acres of land in the State
- ‘Jolting’ expenditures on felicitations ‘running into crores’



and other BCI office-bearers are “permanent managing trustees”; a ‘tie-up’ between the Trust and the Goa government to set up a university on 56 acres of land in the State; “jolting” expenditures on felicitations “running into crores”; and an extension

of the tenure of BCI chairperson/vice-chairperson to five years.

Justice Joymalya Bagchi, part of the Bench, said the top court did not want to encourage “shadow-boxing” around these allegations, but would certainly intervene to “maintain the

institutional integrity and credibility” of the BCI till the next bar body elections.

Meanwhile, Mr. Mishra and the current office-bearers would continue pro tem to ensure the BCI’s day-to-day functioning.

“You are a pro tem chairperson. Your term is co-terminus with the elections. The Attorney-General and the Solicitor-General, as permanent ex-officio members of the BCI, would be given prior notice by you and invited to participate in any decision-making process having a policy impact... After all, the Attorney-General is as much a member of the BCI as the chairperson is,” Justice Bagchi observed.

CONTINUED ON
» **PAGE 10**

UN charts course to manage global warming-limit breach

Jacob Koshy
NEW DELHI

Warning that a possible breach of the 1.5 degrees Celsius global warming limit will bring irreversible ecological losses that no adaptation initiatives could undo, the United Nations Environment Programme (UNEP) on Wednesday, for the first time, set out a detailed “overshoot, peak, and decline” pathway.

The pathway projects a trajectory where the world overshoots the 2015 Paris Agreement’s central goal of limiting the rise in average global temperatures to 1.5 degrees Celsius above pre-industrial levels – which a UNEP report said was now unavoidable. The pathway seeks to hold peak temperatures after the overshoot as low as possible and then bring it back down below the limit by 2100.

The report, *Limiting Overshoot*, said global warming would cross 1.5 degrees Celsius “in the

Climate concerns

The UN report proposes a pathway to hold peak global temperature as low as possible in the coming years and bring it back within the accepted limit by 2100

- The report says global warming will cross **1.5°C** ‘in the next few years’ and that this is **no longer avoidable**
- A scenario in which every country delivers on its national climate plan and its net-zero target still puts peak global warming at **1.8°C**
- Current policies point to about **2.6°C** global warming by 2100, with a range of 1.9–3.6°C
- ‘Overshoot, peak, and decline’ is simply **‘the best remaining option’**, the report says



next few years”. Even a scenario in which every country delivers on its national climate plan and net-zero target puts peak warming at 1.8 degrees Celsius, it said. According to the report, current policies point to a rise of about 2.6 degrees Celsius by 2100.

“Overshoot, peak, and decline”, the report said, “is by no means an acceptable or preferred path-

way; it is simply the best remaining option”. “This summer’s scorching heat, raging wildfires, and deadly floods are a warning of what lies ahead. We must make the overshoot as small and short as possible,” UN Secretary-General Antonio Guterres said in a statement.

CONTINUED ON
» **PAGE 10**

Iran targets Gulf nations after U.S. strikes

Associated Press
DUBAI

Iran fired on U.S. allies in the Gulf early on Wednesday following a night of American bombardment

that Iranian officials say included a deadly strike on a wedding party.

Fighting in the region has escalated since the U.S. hit Iranian assets on an island in the Strait of Hor-

muz over the weekend. Iran retaliated by firing missiles at American bases in Jordan that were intercepted. Kuwait and Bahrain said they had also come under attack.

Iran has said four members of its paramilitary Revolutionary Guard died in the U.S. attacks.

FULL REPORT ON
» **PAGE 14**

Allahabad HC quashes DU law student’s NSA detention

Ishita Mishra
NEW DELHI

The Allahabad High Court on Wednesday quashed the detention of a 25-year-old Delhi University (DU) law student under the National Security Act (NSA).

Akriti Chaudhary was among several activists arrested in cases related to the workers’ protest in Noida between April 10 and 18. During the strike, industrial and contractual workers demanded salary hikes and parity with wages paid in neighbouring Haryana. On April 13, the protest had turned violent and roads were blocked.

Ms. Chaudhary has spent nearly five months in custody in connection with the protest.

‘Concocted story’

A Bench of Justice Atul Sreedharan and Justice Achal Sachdev allowed Ms. Chaudhary’s habeas corpus plea and ordered her immediate release, unless she was required in another case. The court also flagged discrepancies in the arrest notice and called the State’s version a “concocted story”.

DETAILS ON
» **PAGE 10**
» **‘FIGHT WILL GO ON’**
» **PAGE 4**



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DUSU poll:
AISA moves
HC against
₹1-lakh bond

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The All India Students' Association (AISA) on Wednesday moved the Delhi High Court against the Delhi University's requirement for candidates to submit an indemnity affidavit and parental surety bond of ₹1 lakh to contest the university's students' union (DUSU) election scheduled for September 18.

The DUSU Election Committee had circulated an affidavit that requires candidates to declare that their parents are aware that they are contesting the election. It also requires parents or guardians to stand as surety for payment of ₹1 lakh in case of any infringement or violation of guidelines.

"Students who come to the university are autonomous adults who, if they so choose, can contest for office without the need of any consent from any authority whatsoever," stated a release issued by AISA.

DUSU Chief Election Officer Raj Kishore Sharma said the provision to furnish a bond of ₹1 lakh was in place during last year's election as well.

Delhi Cabinet clears Ease of Doing Business Bill; no routine checks for 3 years

Proposed law provides for a trust-based inspection mechanism, says CM; describes single-window system for all approvals and NOCs to set up an enterprise as the most important feature of the Bill

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Delhi Cabinet has approved the Delhi Ease of Doing Business Bill, 2026 to bring "fundamental changes" to the process of obtaining approvals, registrations, licences and other clearances to set up enterprises in the Capital, the Chief Minister's Office (CMO) stated in a release on Wednesday.

The statement quoted Chief Minister Rekha Gupta as saying that the most important feature of the proposed law would be a single-window system to facilitate approvals, registrations, no-objection certificates (NOCs), consents, licences, and other clearances through a simple and user-friendly portal.

Using the single-window clearance system, businesses will also be able to obtain sanctions for building plans, approvals from the fire department, and water, drainage and elec-



Chief Minister Rekha Gupta interacting with citizens during a 'Jan Sunwai' event at her camp office in Civil Lines on Wednesday. ANI

tricity connections, the CMO added.

Next steps

The Bill will be sent to the Union Home Ministry for approval, a senior official said. The Ministry is expected to seek the opinion of the Legal Affairs Department as several legal issues are involved. Based on the Ministry's final recommendation, the proposed law may be taken up in Parliament or the Delhi Assembly, the official added.

Sharing more details, the CM said, "Through the Bill, different business-related processes will be brought under a system that is simple, transparent, time-bound, and technology-driven. It seeks to move the relationship between the government and enterprises away from a mechanism based on control and suspicion to one based on trust and ease."

Once the proposed law comes into effect, trust and convenience will be priori-

tised between the government and businesses, Ms. Gupta said, adding that the proposed law provides for an inspection system based on trust.

"No routine inspection will be carried out for three years after an enterprise is registered. However, an inspection may be conducted if a serious complaint is received," the CM said.

Self-declaration will be accepted for businesses considered low risk.

The Delhi State Industrial and Infrastructure Development Corporation will be the nodal agency for all business approvals.

Ms. Gupta said enterprises already registered under the Goods and Services Tax Act, the Food Safety and Standards Act, the Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises Development Act or the four Labour Codes will not need to obtain separate registrations for establishments categorised as 'health-trade' and 'eating house'.

Marked 'shifted', 'absent': voters who submitted SIR forms find names missing from draft roll

Suruchi Kumari
NEW DELHI

Two days after Delhi's draft roll was published under the ongoing special intensive revision (SIR) drive, several voters who submitted their enumeration forms to Booth Level Officers (BLOs) found their names missing from the roll and marked 'permanently shifted' or 'absent/untraceable' despite the forms having been officially signed and digitised.

The Hindu has verified at least 16 such cases. Their names appear on the ASDD ('absent', 'shifted', 'dead', 'duplicate') list that categorises the names left out of the draft roll.

As many as 47.56 lakh names have been removed at the draft stage after their enumeration forms were not received by BLOs, according to an official statement.

'Fix accountability'

Jitendra Kumar, 56, from Mehrauli, who has voted from the same polling booth for a decade, found his name marked 'permanently shifted'.

Of the 907 voters registered at the local polling



Ashish Ranjan's name has been marked 'shifted'. The official EC portal shows that his form had been 'successfully submitted'. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

booth, 896 have been marked 'permanently shifted', including Mr. Kumar. His form had been verified and signed by the BLO, as seen by The Hindu. "Accountability should be fixed and it should be explained how I am marked 'permanently shifted' instead of being told to fill Form 6," he said.

According to the Election Commission (EC), electors whose names have not been included in the draft list are required to submit Form 6 during the claims and objections period ending September 30.

When reached for comment, the BLO said, "I had mapped and digitised nearly 600 forms. Now I don't know why voters are

unable to find their names in the draft roll."

Another case is of Ashish Ranjan from Timarpur. He moved from Bihar and has been enrolled as a Delhi voter since 2014. On the official EC portal, his form is marked as 'successfully submitted'. He also submitted a physical form to his BLO on August 7. However, his name appeared in the ASDD list as 'permanently shifted'.

Mr. Ranjan said he will not fill Form 6. "I am an election researcher... On what basis is one marked 'permanently shifted'? Why is there ambiguity regarding this? Form 6 is for new voters," he said.

'Reasons not known'

A senior official said the reason for such cases was "unknown", but voters whose names are missing from the draft roll would have to enrol afresh by submitting Form 6 along with a declaration form. Regarding Mr. Rajan's case, the BLO concerned said, "I am waiting to get some clarity from the Electoral Registration Officer at the next meeting." The Hindu verified four such cases reported to the Timarpur BLO.

Lured to Jaffrabad for podcast, forced to apologise: Dahiya

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Former Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) spokesperson Vijeta Dahiya on Wednesday claimed that he was lured to Jaffrabad in north-east Delhi on the pretext of

recording a podcast, but a group of men confronted him over videos he had made on Hinduism and forced him to record an apology. Mr. Dahiya said he then fled from the spot and the group chased him up to the Jaffrabad metro

station.

The former CJP spokesperson told The Hindu that the incident happened on August 31 and that he filed a police complaint the same day alleging wrongful restraint, intimidation, and threats. He added that he

also approached the police seeking security.

No FIR lodged

When reached for comment, an officer from the Begampur police station said the complaint has been forwarded to the Jaf-

frabad police station for investigation. An FIR has not yet been registered.

Mr. Dahiya said a person who identified himself as Prince Gaur contacted him on August 5 for the podcast. They then agreed to record it on August 31.

AIIMS sets up inquiry panel over death of minor awaiting surgery

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The All India Institute of Medical Sciences (AIIMS), Delhi on Wednesday said a committee has been constituted to look into the circumstances that led to the death of a 15-year-old girl at the medical facility on Tuesday. The statement

follows allegations by the deceased's family, based in Rajasthan's Kota, that she died while awaiting heart surgery for 13 years. The family also demanded a probe into the death.

Mukesh Pariyani, the girl's father, said they first visited AIIMS in 2012 and the doctors had recommended surgery. However,

he alleged that the hospital performed several tests but not the surgery.

"Following comprehensive evaluation, the treatment team concluded in 2017 that corrective cardiac surgery was not feasible. The family was informed about the clinical assessment and possible prognosis," read a statement issued by AIIMS.

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Contact No.: 9635568412

Advocate: Kushal Sharma
Contact No.: 9811331507

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E-Tenders are invited from eligible tenderers online through <https://tntenders.gov.in> for the following item under "Two part System"

e-tender Ref. No	Name of the Item	Quantity (Nos.)
80/2026	Power-Driven Chaff cutters	3000
81/2026	Genset for Walk-in-Coolers	60
82/2026	Livestock Insurance Services for animals under Free Milch Cow Distribution Scheme and Vetri Magalir Goat Rearing Scheme.	1,60,000 Animals

Individual tender documents with full details can be downloaded at free of cost from <https://tntenders.gov.in> upto **05.10.2026, 11.00 am**
Last date for submission of tenders: **05.10.2026, 11.00 am**
Corrigendum/Addendum to this publication, if any, would appear only on the above website.
DIPR/2751/TENDER/2026 **Chief Executive Officer**

Online Tender Document for M.P. Police

POLICE HEADQUARTER, M.P., BHOPAL

No. PHQ/GB/Prov/Sec-20/Store/565/2026 Bhopal, Dated 31/08/2026

ONLINE TENDER NOTICE

Online tender are invited by Deputy Inspector General of Police (Provisioning) Police Head Quarter, Bhopal for Furniture Items on website <https://mptenders.gov.in/nicgep/app>

S. No.	Item	Qty.	EMD Paid Online Through mptenders.gov.in	Tender Fees (Rs.)
1	Staff Chair	101	19,695.00	2000
2	Steel Almirah	18	8,100.00	
3	Executive Chair	15	8,100.00	
Total EMD & Tender Fees			35,895.00	2000.00

2. Cost of tender document (Tender Fee) is non refundable and cannot be exempted in any condition & must submit online through website <https://mptenders.gov.in/nicgep/app>.
2. Tender document can be download from the website of MP Police (www.mppolice.gov.in)
3. Bids shall be submitted online only at MP Tenders website: <https://mptenders.gov.in/nicgep/app>
4. Critical Date Sheet:

	01/09/2026 Time 17:00 PM
Published Date	01/09/2026 Time 17:00 PM
Bid Document Download Start Date	02/09/2026 Time 12:00 PM
Pre Bid Meeting Date	07/09/2026 Time 13:00 AM
Bid Submission Start Date	09/09/2026 Time 12:00 AM
Bid Submission End Date	14/09/2026 Time 14:00 PM
Bid Opening Date	15/09/2026 Time 16:00 PM

5. Intending Bidders are advised to visit this website regularly till closing date of submission to keep themselves updated as any change/modification in the tender will be intimated through this website only by corrigendum/addendum/amendment.
6. Bids will be opened as per date/time as mentioned in the Tender Critical Date Sheet. After online opening of Technical-Bid the results of their qualification as well Price-Bid opening will be intimated later.

(Sandeep Dixit)
A.I.G. (provision)
For- D.I.G. (provision) PHQ, Bhopal

G18004/26

Government of Odisha
Office of Special Relief Commissioner

NOTICE INVITING EXPRESSION OF INTEREST (EOI)

No. 4797 / R&DM(DM), Dt. 02.09.2026

The Office of the Special Relief Commissioner, Government of Odisha, invites Expression of Interest (EOI) from reputed, technically competent and experienced Agencies/ Firms/ System Integrators having proven experience in Early Warning Dissemination Systems, Public Warning Systems, Emergency Communication Systems, Mass Notification Systems and Disaster Management Communication Technologies for Selection Agency for Establishment, Upgradation, Integration, Operation and Maintenance of Early Warning Dissemination System (EWDS) in the State.

- Detailed document with terms & conditions of EOI can be downloaded from <https://srcodisha.nic.in>
- Last date for submission of EOI : 25th September, 2026 by 15:00 Hrs
- Mode of Submission of Eoi : Online via email : srcodishagov@gmail.com/ Sealed hardcopy to the following address in Registered Post.

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Special Relief Commissioner

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Government of Jammu & Kashmir
OFFICE OF THE EXECUTIVE ENGINEER (JAL SHAKTI)
PHE GROUND WATER DIVISION SRINAGAR
Bagh-i-Ali-Mardan Nowshera Srinagar. e-mail: hakeemmushtaq.75316@jk.gov.in

Public Notice

Attention all individuals, firms, industries, factories Institutes, organizations, workshops (Government/semi government/private) Constructing /operating/using Ground water within their premises / jurisdiction in Kashmir province

As per the regulations outlined by the Jammu & Kashmir Water Resources Regulatory Authority (JKWRA) in 2010 and 2011, with the latest amendments, it is mandatory for all individuals, firms, industries, factories, institutes, organizations, workshops (whether government, semi-government, or private) constructing, operating, or using ground water from bore wells or production wells within their premises or jurisdiction in Kashmir to register these wells with the Department of Public Health Engineering (PHE), Ground Water Division Srinagar. This registration must occur within 15 days from the date of construction. However, most of these entities have failed to do so until now. Therefore, all users are directed to register their bore wells (except for domestic users if the borewells are less than 65 feet deep) within 30 days of issuance of this notice, failure to comply which will result in strict action against defaulters as per the rules governed by JKWRA. Additionally, commercial/ industrial/ institutional users already registered with the department are once again urged to clear all dues within 15 days. Failure clear will lead to the publication of defaulting users' names in newspapers, followed by strict actions in accordance with the rules.

We also seek cooperation from everyone to help regulate and control ground water assets in the Kashmir province. Please report any direct or indirect misuse of ground water in various districts and areas of Kashmir province.

For any information, assistance, complaints, or suggestions, please contact the Nodal Officer at the PHE Ground Water Division: Er. Syed Iqbal Rizvi /9906629565

NO. PHE/GWD/8720-28
Dated: 31/08/2026

Er. Hakeem Mushtaq Ahmad
Executive Engineer
PHE Ground Water Division, Srinagar

DIP/K- 5248/26

BANGALORE WATER SUPPLY AND SEWERAGE BOARD

INVITATION FOR TENDER (only through KPP Portal)

BWSSB invites tenders in two stage tender system from eligible contractors for the following works.

Sl. No.	Name of the Works	Amount Put to Tender
Office of the Chief Engineer (Design, QA & IT), 9th floor, Cauvery Bhavan, K G Road, Bangalore -09		EMD Amount
IFT No. BWSSB/CE(D&QA)/ACE(DJ)/TA/1305/2026-27		Date: 01.09.2026
1.	Work of Construction of Service Station Building at Nellurahalli Lake & Hoodi GLR coming under EE(E-1) Division, Bengaluru.	Rs.1,82,11,995.31 Rs.2,73,200/-
2.	Work of Construction of Sub Division office at Bellandur for AEE(E-1-3), Bengaluru.	Rs.1,90,14,285/- Rs.2,65,300/-
3.	Work of Construction of Division office at R.T. Nagar, Bengaluru.	Rs.1,82,79,622/- Rs.2,44,194/-

For all the above works last date & time for receipt of tenders: **16.09.2026 upto 16.00 hrs.**
Technical bids will be opened on **17.09.2026 at 16.00 hrs.**

Sd/-
Chief Engineer (Design, QA & IT)

The details regarding the tender and participation in the e-Procurement process can be obtained by logging on to <https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in> For further details contact the above signed office during working hours

DIPR/CP/2570/MAA/2026-27

Odisha stares at floods again as rain batters adjoining State

The Hindu Bureau
BHUBANESWAR

The Odisha government on Wednesday warned of another round of flooding in Balasore district as the Subarnarekha river, swollen by heavy rain in neighbouring Jharkhand, was in spate.

Due to heavy rain in Jharkhand, floodwater was entering the Subarnarekha river through 13 gates which were opened at Gauludih barrage.

As against danger level of 10.36 metres in Subarnarekha at Rajghat in Jaleswar, water was flowing above 11.63 metres.

As per Water Resource Department, the water level in Subarnarekha could rise above 11.80 metres by night.

Timings
DELHI

THURSDAY, SEP. 03
RISE 06:00 SET 18:40
RISE 22:28 SET 12:02

FRIDAY, SEP. 04
RISE 06:01 SET 18:39
RISE 23:24 SET 13:10

SATURDAY, SEP. 05
RISE 06:01 SET 18:38
RISE 00:00 SET 14:14

Delhi Weather	max	min
Delhi City	36	28
Safdarjang	36	28
Palam	34	25

Delhi Palam Today 34°C The weather will be warm with uneasy afternoon. Chances of light rain & thunder shower at some places. Night will be comfortable.

Delhi Palam Tomorrow 33°C The weather will be warm. Spell of light rain and thundershower may occur. Night will be comfortable.

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Jharkhand exam ‘scam’: BJP demands CBI probe

Party issues 48-hour ultimatum, warns of protests alongside students if its demands are not met, including the withdrawal of cases as per SC directive

Amit Bhelari
PATNA

A Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) delegation on Wednesday met Chief Secretary Avinash Kumar in Ranchi and submitted a memorandum demanding a CBI inquiry into alleged irregularities in several examinations conducted by the Jharkhand Public Service Commission (JPSC) and Jharkhand Staff Selection Commission (JSSC).

The delegation, led by Jharkhand BJP president Aditya Sahu and Leader of the Opposition Babul Marandi, also demanded immediate withdrawal of cases filed against students across the State in connection with the protests. The BJP issued a 48-hour ultimatum to the State govern-



A BJP delegation led by Jharkhand Leader of Opposition Babul Marandi met the CS.

ment, warning it would launch protests alongside students if the cases are not withdrawn.

‘Denied justice’

Addressing the media after the meeting, Mr. Sahu said the BJP would “hit the streets” in support of students if justice is not delivered within 48 hours. He

told the Chief Secretary that students worked hard for years to prepare for these examinations, but were denied justice because of alleged irregularities within the JPSC and the JSSC, where jobs were “sold” and question papers leaked.

Mr. Sahu also alleged that on the instructions of Chief Minister Hemant Soren, police resorted to baton charges when students were protesting peacefully and constitutionally against the exam “irregularities”. He added that Jharkhand Mukti Morcha workers acted as “goons” and attacked the students.

Citing the Supreme Court’s directive, the letter urged the CS to withdraw all cases registered against Jharkhand students during their “peaceful agitation”.

Delhi Police detains ex-bureaucrat over online activity, releases him later

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Delhi Police’s Special Cell on Wednesday detained former bureaucrat Ashish Joshi and questioned him for several hours in connection with a case regarding his online activity before allowing him to go home. Taking to social media later in the evening, Mr. Joshi confirmed that officials had dropped him back at his residence.

During morning walk Mr. Joshi, a 1992-batch Indian Post and Telecommunication Accounts and Finance Service (IP&TAFS) officer who retired as an Additional Secretary-rank official on March 31, was picked up during his morning walk.

Two men in plain clothes approached him at Nehru Park and asked him to accompany them to the Special Cell’s office in New Friends Colony.



Ashish Joshi. FILE PHOTO

The development triggered concern among his acquaintances and drew allegations on social media that he had been taken away by police personnel without his whereabouts being disclosed.

Former Congress MLA Sandeep Dikshit, a friend of Mr. Joshi from college days, said he learnt of the incident from Mr. Joshi’s wife after failing to reach him on phone.

“This morning my good friend and someone assisting me in reaching out to civil society Ashish Joshi ...

Joshi was suspended by the Centre in Feb. 2019 after he sought action against what he called ‘incendiary’ social media posts by Kapil Mishra, then with AAP

has been taken away by two police constables from Nehru Park,” Mr. Dikshit said in his post on X, urging Delhi Police to clarify where he had been taken.

Congress leader Supriya Shrinete also said Mr. Joshi had been picked up by two plainclothes Delhi Police personnel during his morning walk.

“Is the Modi government so uncomfortable with his social media posts that it has to resort to this?” she wrote on X.

Transparency activist Anjali Bharadwaj urged the police to immediately clarify whether Mr. Joshi had

been detained, disclose his whereabouts and state the legal provisions under which he had allegedly been taken into custody.

No details given

Delhi Police did not immediately disclose details of the case in which Mr. Joshi was questioned or the specific online activity under investigation.

The allegations came against the backdrop of Mr. Joshi’s recent social media activity, including X posts on the police action against students protesting at Jantar Mantar, the Q1 GDP figures and “failures” in infrastructure projects.

Mr. Joshi had earlier been suspended by the Union government in February 2019 after he sought action against what he described as “incendiary” social media posts by then Aam Aadmi Party legislator Kapil Mishra, who later joined the Bharatiya Janata Party.

‘AAP playing politics with 1984 riots victims’

Press Trust of India
CHANDIGARH

Senior BJP leader H.S. Phoolka on Wednesday questioned the presence of an Aam Aadmi Party (AAP) MLA from Delhi at former Congress MP Sajjan Kumar’s condolence meeting and accused the party of “playing politics with the victims of the 1984 anti-Sikh riots”.

Addressing a press conference here, the noted Supreme Court lawyer said those who genuinely stood



BJP leader H.S. Phoolka.

FILE PHOTO

with the victims could not simultaneously express solidarity with those convicted of crimes against them.

Bharatiya Janata Party

(BJP) president Nitin Nabin had summoned three BJP MPs and expressed displeasure over their visit to Kumar’s residence to offer condolences, said Mr. Phoolka, who was flanked by the party’s Punjab media head Vineet Joshi.

Sajjan Kumar, who was serving two life sentences in connection with the riots, died at Safdarjung Hospital in Delhi on August 20.

On the presence of Badarpur MLA Ram Singh Ne-taji at Kumar’s condolence meeting, Mr. Phoolka asked

the Arvind Kejriwal-led party what action it took against its legislator.

Neither did AAP do anything for the riot victims nor did it do anything to ensure punishment for the guilty, he said. “It only played politics over this issue,” he alleged. The victims waited for decades for justice and their suffering should not be reduced to a political tool, he said. The Narendra Modi government announced an additional ₹5 lakh compensation for each victim family, he said.

Gurugram MP seeks action-taken report on drain encroachments

The Hindu Bureau
GURUGRAM

Union Minister of State and Gurugram MP Rao Inderjit Singh on Wednesday expressed regret to residents affected by the recent waterlogging and said a permanent solution would require restoring the city’s natural drainage system, maximising rainwater harvesting and recharging groundwater.

At a meeting with senior

officials of the Gurugram Metropolitan Development Authority, Municipal Corporation of Gurugram and district administration, Mr. Singh sought an action-taken report on notices issued by Irrigation Department officials to builders over encroachments on natural drains.

He directed Urban Development Adviser and former Chief Secretary D.S. Dhesi to coordinate among the civic bodies and de-

partments to formulate a comprehensive, long-term policy on waterlogging. He also sought a detailed report on encroachments on nearly half a dozen ponds and natural drains. Mr. Singh said natural drainage routes had been affected by development and construction, particularly by licences issued between 2004 and 2012.

Mr. Singh warned that encroachments on natural drains must be removed.

**GOVERNMENT OF GOA
PUBLIC WORKS DEPARTMENT
DIVISION VIII (BLDGs-SOUTH), FATORDA, MARGAO-GOA.**

E-TENDER NOTICE No.:
PWD/DIV.8(B.S)/ASW/2001/20/2026-2027 Dated: 01-09-2026
(E-TENDER & E-PAYMENT MODE ONLY)

1	Last date of online submission of tender for the work at Sr.No. 01	:	08/09/2026 upto 11.00 A.M.
2	Last date of online submission of tender for the work at Sr.No. 02, 03, 04, 05 & 06	:	07/09/2026 upto 11.00 A.M.
3	Opening of online Tenders for the work at Sr.No. 01	:	10/09/2026 after 10.00 A.M.
4	Opening of online Tenders for the work at Sr.No. 02, 03, 04, 05 & 06	:	09/09/2026 after 10.00 A.M.

For more details please contact: Office of The Executive Engineer, Works Division VIII (Bldgs-South), PWD, Fatorda, Margao-Goa.
Website: <https://eprocure.goa.gov.in/>
Sd/-
Executive Engineer-VIII
Division VIII (Bldgs-South) P.W.D

DI/ADVT/1365/2026

**UNION TERRITORY OF JAMMU & KASHMIR
OFFICE THE EXECUTIVE ENGINEER PWD (R&B) PROJECT
DIVISION- III, JAMMU**

SHORT NOTICE INVITING TENDER
Short e-NIT No. 48 of 2026-2027 Dated 31-08-2026

For and on behalf of the Lieutenant Governor, Union Territory of Jammu and Kashmir e-tenders are invited on percentage basis from approved and eligible Contractors registered with Union Territory of J&K, CPWD, Railways, MES and other State/Central Governments for each of the following works :-

S. No	Name of Work	Name of Division	Advised Cost (Rs in Lacs)	Cost of document (in Rs)	Earnest Money (in Rs)	Time Allowed for completion	Time and date of opening of tender	Class of Contractor
1	Qtr. No. 53, Block C, TSK, Jammu (Wall panelling and completion of woodwork for the cupboards), CNo-142 P	PWD (R&B) Project Div. III, Jammu	1.92	600	2% of Advertised Cost	30 Days	(1300 Hrs) on or after 08-09-2026	A,B,C & D
2	Upgradation of Qtr. No.441 Block S Toph Sherkhanya, renovation of Wall by new POP or PVC panelling Alongside with Windows. CNo-143 P	PWD (R&B) Project Div. III, Jammu	1.92	600	2% of Advertised Cost	30 Days	(1300 Hrs) on or after 08-09-2026	A,B,C & D
3	Upgradation of Set no. 547 Block-W Toph Sherkhanya, Tiling of Walls and electric fitting. CNo-144 P	PWD (R&B) Project Div. III, Jammu	0.96	600	2% of Advertised Cost	15 Days	(1300 Hrs) on or after 08-09-2026	A,B,C & D
4	Upgradation of Qtr. No. 21, 23, 379, 401,435,497,498,515,516,526,277, 439,461 and 586 including necessary civil works of various blocks at housing colony Toph Sherkhania. CNo-145 P	PWD (R&B) Project Div. III, Jammu	28.80	600	2% of Advertised Cost	120 Days	(1300 Hrs) on or after 08-09-2026	A & B
5	External face lifting of walls of Block C,D,E,F,G,H,I,K,L,Q,R,S,T,U,V,W and X by way of construction of new sunshades, repairing of damaged parapet walls including water proofing in various blocks and some other allied works at Toph Sherkhania, Jammu. CNO-146 P	PWD (R&B) Project Div. III, Jammu	33.60	600	2% of Advertised Cost	120 Days	(1300 Hrs) on or after 08-09-2026	A & B
6	Construction of steel wardrobe /C.I. wardrobes at Toph Sherkhania Housing Colony, Jammu. CNO - 147 P	PWD (R&B) Project Div. III, Jammu	14.40	600	2% of Advertised Cost	100 Days	(1300 Hrs) on or after 08-09-2026	A,B,C & D
7	Laying of chequered tiles in U block, between Q and R block, between S and T block and some other allied works at Toph Sherkhania, Jammu. CNO-148 P	PWD (R&B) Project Div. III, Jammu	14.40	600	2% of Advertised Cost	60 Days	(1300 Hrs) on or after 08-09-2026	A,B,C & D
8	Upgradation of boundary wall by way of plastering of walls, repair of gates and other allied works at Toph Sherkhania, Jammu. CNO-149 P	PWD (R&B) Project Div. III, Jammu	9.60	600	2% of Advertised Cost	60 Days	(1300 Hrs) on or after 08-09-2026	A,B,C & D
9	Upgradation of Quarter No. 408 Block R, Toph Sherkhania, Subash Nagar, Jammu. CNO-150 P	PWD (R&B) Project Div. III, Jammu	3.84	600	2% of Advertised Cost	45 Days	(1300 Hrs) on or after 08-09-2026	A,B,C & D
10	Upgradation of Set No. 578-Y, Block Y, Toph Sherkhanya, Jammu by way of Kitchen Washroom Tiling window doors etc. CNO-151 P	PWD (R&B) Project Div. III, Jammu	1.92	600	2% of Advertised Cost	30 Days	(1300 Hrs) on or after 08-09-2026	A,B,C & D
11	Lying of interlocking tiles in the periphery of colony from Block A to M, renovation of all the bathrooms affected due to improvement of the external sewerage line from Block A to M, renovation of sewerage line from individual bathroom to manhole of all the blocks including construction of manholes from Block A to M, construction of open drain from front and back side of all blocks from A to M at Tophsherkhania, Jammu. CNO-152 P	PWD (R&B) Project Div. III, Jammu	58.80	600	2% of Advertised Cost	100 Days	(1300 Hrs) on or after 08-09-2026	A

Position of AAS : Accorded
Position of TTA : Under Process

The Bidding documents Consisting of qualifying information, eligibility criteria, specifications, Drawings, bill of quantities (B.O.Q), Set of terms and conditions of contract and other details can be seen/downloaded from the departmental website <http://jtenders.gov.in> as per below schedule:-

1	Date of Issue of Tender Notice	31-08-2026
2	Period of downloading of bidding documents	From 31-08-2026to 07-09-2026 upto 1800 Hrs
3	Date, Time and place of pre-bid meeting	03-08-2026 at 1200Hrs. in the Office of Executive Engineer PWD (R&B) Project Division III, Jammu
4	Bid submission Start Date	31-08-2026
5	Bid Submission End Date	07-09-2026 upto 1800 Hrs
6	Date & time of opening of Technical Bids (Online)	08-09-2026 on or after 1300 Hrs in the Office of Executive Engineer PWD (R&B) Project Division III, Jammu
7	Date & time of opening of Financial Bids	To be notified after technical bid evaluation is completed

No :-PWD(R&B)/PD-III/5776-88
Dated :-31-08-2026

(Er. Rahat Gupta)
Executive Engineer
Project Division III
Jammu

DIP/J-9167/26 Sep 1 2026

KARNATAKA INDUSTRIAL AREAS DEVELOPMENT BOARD
(A Government of Karnataka Undertaking)
No.2, 2/1 and 2/3, Kalidasa Marg, 1st Main Road, Gandhinagar, Bengaluru-560009. Phone No. 080-22265383, Website: www.kiadb.in

No. IADB/ENGG/ETND-EP-34/1422/2026-27 Date: 01.09.2026

SHORT TERM NOTICE INVITING TENDER
(Through GOK Karnataka Public Procurement Portal Only)

Item Rate Tenders under two cover bid system are invited as per the Karnataka Transparency in Public Procurement Act 1999 and Rules 2000 through electronic procurement from eligible Contractors who have got adequate financial resources, state of the art technology, suitable construction equipments, technical man power & sufficient past experience for the work of :

Name of the Works: Formation of Balance Industrial Layout including formation of 30m,18m & 15m wide roads including Asphaltting, Construction of RCC Side Drains, RCC Cross drainage works at Masthenahalli Industrial Area, 2nd Phase, Chinthamani Taluk, Chikkaballapura District.

The last date and time of receipt of tender is : **17.09.2026 upto 4.00 pm.**

Applicants May Download Bidding Documents from the Karnataka Public Procurement Portal <https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in>.

Sd/-
Engineer in Chief, KIADB, Bengaluru

DIPR/CP/2534/SMCL/2026-27

KARNATAKA INDUSTRIAL AREAS DEVELOPMENT BOARD
(A Government of Karnataka Undertaking)
No.2, 2/1 and 2/3, Kalidasa Marg, 1st Main Road, Gandhinagar, Bengaluru-560009. Phone No. 080-22265383, Website: www.kiadb.in

No. IADB/ENGG/EIA/ETND-EC-04/1423/2026-27 Dated: 01.09.2026

**SHORT TERM NOTICE INVITING TENDER TO
PROVIDE CONSULTANCY SERVICES FOR
OBTAINING ENVIRONMENTAL CLEARANCE (EC)**
(Through GOK Karnataka Public Procurement Portal Only)

KIADB is inviting tender under two cover systems for providing Consultancy Services from Environmental Consultant of NABET under 7(c) category with NABL Accredited Consultant/MOU with NABET & NABL Accredited Consultancy Services Accredited Consultant are eligible to participate in this tenders.

Name of the Works: (1) Providing Consultancy Services for preparing EIA, SIS studies etc., to obtain Environmental Clearance (EC) from State Environmental Impact Assessment Authority(SEIAA) Forest and Climate Change (MoEF&CC) and Consent for Establishment (CFE) from Karnataka State Pollution Control Board (KSPCB) and submission of Half-yearly compliance Report for all the conditions of EC & CFE for 3 years for Kochanahalli 2nd Phase Industrial Area, Mysuru taluk & District in an Extent 403.25 acres. EMD: **Rs. 2.00 Lakhs.**

(2) Providing Consultancy Services for preparing EIA, SIS studies etc., to obtain Environmental Clearance (EC) from State Environmental Impact Assessment Authority(SEIAA) Forest and Climate Change (MoEF&CC) and Consent for Establishment (CFE) from Karnataka State Pollution Control Board (KSPCB) and submission of Half-yearly compliance Report for all the conditions of EC & CFE for 3 years for Masthenahalli 3rd Phase Industrial Area, Chintamani taluk, Chikkaballapura District in an Extent 614.98 acres. EMD: **Rs. 2.00 Lakhs.**

Scheduled of dates are as follows :

- Last date to receive pre bid Queries: **09.09.2026 up to 4:00 pm**
- Pre bid meeting will be held on: **09.09.2026 at 4.30 pm**
- Last date for submission of bids is: **17.09.2026 upto 04:00 pm**
- Time and date of opening Technical bids is on: **18.09.2026 at 04:30 pm**

Applicants May Download Bidding Documents from the Karnataka Public Procurement Portal <https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in>.

Sd/-
Engineer in Chief, KIADB, Bengaluru

DIPR/CP/2535/SMCL/2026-27

APPOINTMENT

कोचीन शिपयार्ड लिमिटेड
भारत सरकार की सेवा : 1 शिपियार्ड, पाम, पोर्ट परियोजना और जलमार्ग संवर्धन
COCHIN SHIPYARD LIMITED
A Government of India Category-I, Miniratna Company, Ministry of Ports, Shipping and Waterways

No. CSL/P&A/RECT/CANSRU CONT/NOTIFICATION 11/SPO&P/2026/2 Date: 14.08.2026

CSL AN SHIP REPAIR UNIT(CANSRU), SRI VIJAYA PURAM
REQUIRES SENIOR PROJECT OFFICER/ PROJECT OFFICER ON CONTRACT BASIS

Cochin Shipyard Limited (CSL), a listed premier Mini Ratna Schedule 'A' Company of Govt of India, invites **Online application** for Senior Project Officer/ Project Officer on Contract Basis for CSL AN Ship Repair Unit (CANSRU), Sri Vijaya Puram.

Sl. No.	Name of Posts	No. of Vacancies
1	Senior Project Officer (Safety)	1 Post (UR)
2	Project Officer (Safety)	1 Post (UR)

For more details on **Age, Reservation, Educational Qualification, Experience, Remuneration** etc., please read the vacancy notification on CSL website www.cochinshipyard.in (Career page—CANSRU (ANDAMAN)). Last date of receipt of online application is 14.09.2026.

“Hindi version of detailed advertisement is published on the website (www.cochinshipyard.in) of CSL.”

Sd/-
GENERAL MANAGER (HR&LD)

INBRIEF



Bengal CM drives road roller over cough syrup bottles

West Bengal Chief Minister Suwendu Adhikari on Wednesday drove a road roller over two lakh bottles of codeine-based cough syrup in Balurghat, saying the State is committed to fight against drug abuse. He was accompanied by Balurghat MP Sukanta Majumdar and Health Minister Sharadwat Mukherjee at the event in Dakshin Dinajpur district. The banned cough syrup bottles were lined up outside the Superintendent of Police's office. The CM drove the roller over the bottles as a message against drug abuse and drug peddling in the State and a warning to smugglers.

Tiger kills sanitation worker as guard opens enclosure

A woman sanitation worker was mauled to death by a tiger in Nahargarh Biological Park in Jaipur on Wednesday, when a forest guard allegedly opened the gate of its enclosure oblivious of a group of women working inside, officials said. The forest department has suspended the guard and ordered an inquiry, while the victim's family and villagers staged a protest demanding compensation. The deceased was identified as Sugna Devi, a resident of Nagal Susawatan village. According to officials, six to seven women were cutting grass inside enclosure no. 16 when the tiger, named Shivaji, suddenly entered it. The tiger attacked Sugna on the neck, killing her.

Rahul's Indore event postponed after stadium nod denied: Cong.

Press Trust of India
INDORE

The Congress on Wednesday said party leader Rahul Gandhi's 'Chhatron Ki Goonj' event in Indore, earlier planned to be held on September 12, has been postponed to September 19 due to the State government's denial of permission to use a city-based stadium as the programme venue.

State Congress president Jitu Patwari made the announcement during a meeting held to take stock of the preparations for the event.

He said that the State government denied permission to hold 'Chhatron Ki Goonj' at the Jawaharlal Nehru Stadium here and the party will now find a new venue for the event and make preparations accordingly.

Earlier, Mr. Patwari wrote a letter to Chief Minister Mohan Yadav requesting him to make the



Congress leader Rahul Gandhi addressing a gathering during a 'Chhatron Ki Goonj' programme in Pune. FILE PHOTO: ANI

stadium available for the September 12 event.

In the letter, he said Mr. Gandhi's programme is not a typical political event, but a public dialogue focused on important issues such as the country's future, the dreams of youth, the right to education, and the security of the education system.

Nehru Stadium falls under the jurisdiction of the Indore Municipal Corporation.

Mayor Pushyamitra Bhargava said that the Madhya Pradesh High

Court has clearly stated that only sports activities or State-level government programmes can be permitted at the stadium.

Mobilising students

The Congress is trying to mobilise 50,000 students from Indore and surrounding areas for the programme.

'Chhatron Ki Goonj' is a student-dialogue campaign launched by the Congress, under which programmes are being organised in various cities across the country.

Inside Delhi prisons: a web of gangs, collusion and proposed transfers

Lavpreet Kaur
NEW DELHI

On April 6 this year, a clash among inmates inside Mandoli jail left a 22-year-old murder accused seriously injured. Three months later, the Delhi government's Anti-Corruption Branch arrested 11 people, including seven prison officials, in an alleged extortion and bribery racket involving prisons in Tihar, Rohini and Mandoli.

The incidents have again put the functioning of Delhi's prisons under scrutiny amid concerns over gang rivalries, contraband, staff collusion and communication between inmates and associates outside. The concern is particularly significant given the presence of several high-profile gangsters and or-



Gangsters such as Neeraj Bawana (left) have been lodged in Tihar jail since 2015; Lawrence Bishnoi was lodged in Tihar and Mandoli prisons while facing trial between 2021 and 2023. FILE PHOTOS

ganised criminals across the city's three major prison complexes. Gangsters such as Neeraj Bawana and Chhota Rajan have been lodged in Tihar jail since 2015, while Hashim Baba has been there since 2019 and is allegedly operating his syndicate from behind bars. Anmol Bishnoi has also been in high-security custody in Tihar jail since November 2025.

Against this backdrop,



the Delhi government is considering transferring "hardened and notorious" prisoners, including undertrial gangsters, organised criminals and other high-risk inmates, to prisons in other States under the Transfer of Prisoners (Punjab Amendment) Act, 2025. The proposed move would allow undertrials to be transferred to prisons outside the State besides convicted prisoners. The

history of Lawrence Bishnoi, who was lodged in Tihar and Mandoli prisons while facing trial before being shifted to Sabarmati Central Jail in Gujarat, also highlights the relevance of allowing undertrials to be transferred between States.

Prison promises

Former inmates who spent five to 20 years in Delhi prisons told *The Hindu* that they were approached with offers of money, help in court cases and other favours. "During my first interim bail, after four and a half years in prison, I was offered ₹10 lakh to carry out a 'task' and promised help with my case," said a former inmate lodged in a murder case.

Sunil Kumar Gupta, a former legal adviser, superintendent and spokesper-

son of Central Jail in Tihar, said gang members identify 'useful' inmates and exploit vulnerabilities such as financial distress, pending cases and drug dependence. "Once trust is established, recruits may be used to move contraband, extort money or carry out crimes after release or while on bail," he said.

Mr. Gupta said transferring gang leaders could disrupt such networks, but warned that influential prisoners could try to manipulate the process.

'Not all gaps closed'

Technology, meanwhile, has not closed all the gaps. A prison official, speaking on condition of anonymity, said inmates continued to find ways around mobile phone jammers by exploiting weak coverage, using newer networks or having

equipment tampered with, sometimes with staff support. Contraband can enter through visitors, parcels and mail, over prison walls or during court movements, the official said. "Prisons need better screening equipment, including body scanners and X-ray systems," he added.

Mr. Gupta said staff shortages, inadequate training and the perception of jail duty as a "punishment posting" have made prisons vulnerable to collusion.

While the proposed transfers may help reduce some links between gangs inside and outside prisons, their effectiveness would also depend on addressing issues such as staff shortages, corruption and gaps in supervision, which can allow such networks to persist or adapt.

Relieved by HC order but my fight will go on till all workers come out: Akriti

Hope Satyam is also freed of all charges, says DU student about fellow prison inmate who was also booked under NSA; knew she had done nothing wrong, says father, calls her 'today's Bhagat Singh'

Shrimansi Kaushik
NEW DELHI

Akriti Chaudhary, the 25-year-old Delhi University student, expressed relief over the Allahabad High Court order quashing the National Security Act (NSA) against her. However, her struggle will continue until the release of all those jailed following the workers' protest in April this year, she added.

"The NSA charge being quashed is a great relief but the fight will not end until the release of all workers and activists," she told *The Hindu* at the prison in Greater Noida.

Ms. Chaudhary then turned to Satyam Verma, the other individual against whom the police had invoked the stringent law on May 13, and said, "Hopefully he is also freed of all the charges."

Tears were clearly visible on her face behind an iron mesh barrier, where



The 25-yr.-old student said she has kept herself busy in prison by teaching children of fellow women inmates. FILE PHOTO

she stood with other activists waiting to meet friends and family.

'Proud of daughter'

Her father, Arun Chaudhary, said, "My daughter is the Bhagat Singh of today. She always had full support from us. We never felt she had done anything wrong. I have full faith in the justice system."

"A cheerful and sensitive person such as Akriti can never pose any kind of

threat to national security. But she was declared a threat to the nation just for trying to create a better society. Even the NSA could not break her courage," said Naureen, a history graduate and friend.

Ms. Chaudhary hails from Durgapur in West Bengal and is in her first year of LLB at DU's Law Faculty.

Life in jail

Speaking about her experience in prison, Ms. Chaudhary said she took the initiative to cook and clean, and also taught the children of women inmates. Along with Manisha Chauhan and Srishti, who were also taken into custody by the Uttar Pradesh police in protest-related cases, she said she restarted a defunct library and encouraged others to read.

"We have been working because there is nothing wrong with maintaining and taking care of the place we live in," said the

DU student. The three also attended various vocational classes in the prison, including tailoring and cosmetics, she said.

"Our schedule involves regular work. Besides that, we teach children. We have made posters, written poems, decorated our library and common rooms, and started a culture of reading and discussion. It worked as a distraction for women arrested for participating in the protest and helped ease the sadness that followed as they were separated from their families," she said.

Ms. Chaudhary is also a theatre practitioner and is associated with the Disha Students' Organisation. She studied history at DU's Daulat Ram College.

She was one of the four persons arrested by police from Botanical Garden metro station on April 11, two days before the violence.

CONCORTED STORY: HC
» PAGE 10

T.N. govt. to withdraw cases against farmers and teachers filed during DMK regime

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay on Wednesday announced the withdrawal of cases filed against protesting farmers and teachers between 2021 and 2026 during the previous DMK regime.

Making a *suo motu* statement in the Assembly, he said the government would respect the democratic rights of farmers and teachers who had protested peacefully.

"The government has decided to withdraw the cases on humanitarian grounds, and in accordance with democratic norms," he said.

'Goondas Act invoked'

Mr. Vijay said the Goondas Act had been invoked against farmers in Tiruvannamalai district who had opposed the acquisition of their lands for a SIPCOT industrial park.

"Cases were filed in an inhumane manner against farmers who had fought against the acquisition of water bodies and agricultural lands, as it would affect their livelihoods. The cases



Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay

had been pending. Now, the government has decided to withdraw them," he said.

Standard practice: DMK Senior DMK leader T.K.S. Elangovan downplayed the political significance of Mr. Vijay's decision, calling it standard administrative practice.

He noted that previous administrations have routinely taken similar steps.

Mr. Elangovan explained that while police immediately register cases for property damage during agitations, governments generally do not press those charges once they consider the underlying reasons for the protests.

"That is what Mr. Vijay has also done," he added. (With PTI inputs)



Deputy CM Brajesh Pathak (right) meeting aspirants after they staged a protest outside his residence on Wednesday. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

demands," he said.

The Deputy Chief Minister added that all students desire a speedy resolution. "I have just directed the UPSSSC Chairman to ensure that the typing examination is held promptly in accordance with the students' demands," he said.

'False assurances'

The aspirants said they have been waiting for the typing test for a long time.

"We met the Deputy Chief Minister regarding

be considered and that they are deliberating on it.

"We want them to issue an official notice confirming that the typing test for the 3,284 vacant posts will take place in October. It is already significantly delayed," Mr. Mishra said.

Meanwhile, the Opposition Congress extended support to the aspirants' demands and alleged that the Bharatiya Janata Party government in the State has "failed" in providing employment to the youth.

"The government made tall promises about employment generation, but it has completely failed. Aspirants were forced to reach the Deputy CM's residence for regular and time-bound recruitment. The recruitment calendar is not being followed. Our leader Rahul Gandhiji was in Prayagraj holding a dialogue with the youth. We will support them in every way possible," Congress national secretary Shah Nawaz Alam said.

Helicopter 'misuse' plea against Naveen, Pandian nixed

Press Trust of India
BHUBANESWAR

A court here on Wednesday dismissed a criminal revision petition against former Chief Minister Naveen Patnaik and ex-IAS officer V.K. Pandian in an alleged expenditure of around ₹500 crore from the State exchequer by undertaking 300 helicopter tours.

Khurda District Sessions Judge Biranchi Narayan Mohanty said the petitioner failed to substantiate any offence, did not follow the mandatory procedure under the Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, and lacked locus standi to file the complaint.

The court also found no illegality in the March 25 order of the Sub-Divisional Judicial Magistrate, Bhubaneswar, which dismissed the original complaint. The revision petition was rejected as "devoid of merit," the court order said.

Maharashtra roll: Cong. seeks extension of time for filing of objections

Press Trust of India
MUMBAI

With 2.06 crore names in Maharashtra not figuring in the draft electoral roll following a special intensive revision (SIR), the State Congress on Wednesday demanded that sufficient time be given for filing claims and objections.

It also demanded that the hearing process be made more convenient, and the entire exercise be conducted in a transparent manner.

2.06 cr. names deleted

More than 2.06 crore names, accounting for 21.14% of the State's previous voter base, have not

figured in the draft electoral roll. The draft roll currently has more than 7.71 crore names (78.86% of the previous electorate), comprising 3.95 crore men, 3.75 crore women, and 3,087 third-genders, according to State election authorities.

The Congress sought extension of the deadline for claims and objections until November 30.

The current period from August 31 to September 30 is insufficient. Moreover, the Ganesh festival falls during this period, when many citizens travel to their native places. Therefore, the deadline for filing claims and objections should be extended until November 30, 2026, it said.

Formulate rules for fishing vessel transit to EEZ, SC directs T.N.

Krishnadas Rajagopal
NEW DELHI

Seeking cooperative federalism between the Centre and the State to regulate purse seine fishing, the Supreme Court on Wednesday directed Tamil Nadu to frame rules to create a “specified channel” or official navigation corridor under the Marine Fishing Regulation Rules, 2020 for transit of vessels from its territorial waters to Exclusive Economic Zones (EEZ) for fishing using such nets.

The direction by a Division Bench headed by Justices P.S. Narasimha and Alok Aradhe was part of a judgment that considered applications concerning the rights of fishermen using purse seine nets to access the EEZ beyond the territorial waters of the State of Tamil Nadu.

Tamil Nadu had banned fishing by purse seine nets within its territorial waters in 2000. The State had expressed concern that fishermen could use purse seine nets within its territorial waters under the guise of fishing in the EEZ. It would be difficult for the State to regulate it.

On the other hand, the fishing community had argued that Tamil Nadu was invoking the 2020 Rules, notified to enforce the State’s ban, to prevent them from even carrying these purse seine nets to the EEZ for fishing beyond 12 nautical miles, which is outside the remit of State.

But the court said fishing within and outside the territorial waters of the



State was covered by Tamil Nadu Marine Fishing Regulation Rules, 2020, and the Central law of Sustainable Harnessing of Fisheries in the Exclusive Economic Zone Rules (EEZ Rules), 2025. The 2020 Rules regulate fishing within Tamil Nadu’s territorial waters and the use of gear.

The EEZ Rules contemplate the issuance of ‘access pass’ to fishing vessels permitted in the EEZ. Upholding both the 2020 and 2025 Rules, the court directed that the “rights and liabilities of the parties will now be governed as per the relevant laws, EEZ Rules, 2025 and the Tamil Nadu Marine Fishing Regulation Rules, 2020”.

“We now have the entire legal regime through which purse seine fishing can be regulated in the EEZ, while addressing the concerns of the State... There is no conflict between the EEZ Rules of the Union and the Marine Fishery Regulation Rules, 2020 of the State of Tamil Nadu,” the court observed.

Agniveer involvement ruled out in military weapon theft

Military Intelligence has joined the investigation into the missing service weapons from 20 Madras Regiment premises in Secunderabad; probe being conducted from an undisclosed location

Naveen Kumar
HYDERABAD

The Malkajigiri Police have reportedly ruled out the involvement of Agniveers in the theft of service weapons and ammunition from the 20 Madras Regiment premises in Bollaram, Secunderabad Cantonment, even as the investigation continues under heightened secrecy inside the defence area.

Military Intelligence has also joined the investigation into the theft, with the probe being conducted from within the defence area at an undisclosed location to maintain confidentiality.



Missing gear: The stolen service weapons include four AK-203 assault rifles and six 9mm pistols. IMAGE FOR REPRESENTATION

Sources said even staff at the Bollaram Police Station were not aware of the status of the investigation or the details of the probe.

The restrictions on shar-

ing information come amid heightened security following the theft of four AK-203 assault rifles, an INSAS IB1 rifle, six 9 mm Auto 1A pistols and a civilian 6.35-bore pistol from the

Army premises. A passive night-vision binocular and more than 1,800 rounds of ammunition were also reported missing.

The discrepancy was detected around 7.50 a.m. on Monday when the Kote and Battalion Magazine was opened and the locks were found broken. The weapons and ammunition were last physically accounted for around 6 p.m. on August 30.

The Army subsequently reverified its weapon and ammunition holdings and accounting records, searched authorised storage areas and adjoining premises and checked issue and receipt registers.

Sunni leader’s observations on women unsuitable for modern Keralam, says CM

The Hindu Bureau
THIRUVANANTHAPURAM

Rejecting Sunni leader Kanthapuram A.P. Aboobacker Musliar’s recent controversial opinions against the participation of women in public platforms, Chief Minister V.D. Satheesan said his comments are unsuitable for modern and progressive Keralam.

Addressing a press conference in Thiruvananthapuram on Wednesday

after the Cabinet meeting, Mr. Satheesan said that neither the Congress nor the State government can agree with such a stand that belongs to the 19th century.

“Even Islamic history and its scriptures say that women have a place in public spaces. Such comments are a result of misinterpretation of Islam. Khadija, the first wife of the Prophet, was a businesswoman, while Ayesha, another wife, had led an



V.D. Satheesan

army in a war. Women’s voices were respected in the court of Khalifa Umar,” Mr. Satheesan said.

Meanwhile, the Kerala Muslim Jamaat con-

demned Mr. Satheesan’s remarks that Mr. Aboobacker Musliar had misinterpreted Islam. It demanded that the Chief Minister withdraw the statement and apologise to the Muslim community.

The Muslim Jamaat said Mr. Satheesan had misunderstood Islamic history and commented on them without properly considering their context. Such remarks, it said, were unbecoming of the office of the Chief Minister.

INBRIEF



Aero India 2027 to be held in Bengaluru from February 8

Aero India, Asia’s largest air show and among the world’s premier aerospace and defence exhibitions, will return for its 16th edition at Air Force Station, Yelahanka, in Bengaluru from February 8 to 12, 2027. Exhibitor registrations are scheduled to begin on September 3, 2026. A major attraction of the event will be aerial displays by the Indian Air Force and participating international flying teams. Aero India 2027 is being organised by the Department of Defence Production under the Ministry of Defence.

Keralam seeks technical study of Mullaperiyar Dam

Keralam has demanded a rigorous, long-term technical evaluation of the Mullaperiyar Dam before the five-member comprehensive safety panel. The State submitted an eight-page written document detailing its safety concerns. Both Keralam and Tamil Nadu presented their arguments during the meeting, officials said. The demand comes as the panel began inspection of the main dam, baby dam, earthen dam, and spillway on Tuesday. The panel’s chairman, former NHPG CMD Balraj Joshi, said that the committee will submit its report in two weeks.

Karnataka all for NITI Aayog’s ‘second Bengaluru’ proposal

The NITI Aayog has suggested that the Karnataka consider building a “second Bengaluru” in the State to reduce the pressure on the capital. The suggestion came from NITI Aayog Vice-Chairman Ashok Kumar Lahiri during a meeting with Chief Minister D.K. Shivakumar in Bengaluru on Wednesday. “I am proud of Karnataka’s development. To reduce pressure on Bengaluru, there is a need to seriously consider building a second Bengaluru in Karnataka,” said Mr. Lahiri. The Chief Minister said a proper plan would be prepared as per NITI Aayog’s expectations.

Godavari reaches north A.P. through Polavaram canal

Hareesh.P
PAYAKARAOPET

Andhra Pradesh Chief Minister N. Chandrababu Naidu on Wednesday laid out a road map for augmenting water supply to the Uttaraandhra region through various projects and interlinking of rivers.

Releasing the Godavari water to the north Andhra region through the Polavaram Left Main Canal at PL Puram village in Anakapalli district on Wednesday, he said: “I had promised to bring the Godavari water to Uttaraandhra and fulfilled it,” he said. He thanked Prime Minister Narendra Modi for the merger of seven mandals in Telangana with Andhra Pradesh, without which Polavaram project would have remained a dream.

The project, executed at a cost of ₹4,192 crore, will



N. Chandrababu Naidu joins the prayers before opening the gates of Polavaram Left Main Canal in Anakapalli on Wednesday.

ensure water for irrigating four lakh acres, drinking water to 9.23 lakh people, and will meet the industrial needs of East Godavari, Kakinada, Konaseema, Anakapalli, and Visakhapatnam districts. He said 72% of Polavaram project works had been completed by 2019, but the previous government had neglected the project.

“With the blessings of Annavaram Satyanarayana

Swamy, we have brought the Godavari river water to Anakapalli. By next year, water will reach near Simhadri Appanna (Simhachalam in Visakhapatnam) and Suryanarayana Swamy at Arasavalli in future, realising the goal of interlinking of the Godavari with the Vamsadhara river. We will offer ‘Jala Harathi’ to every acre of land by interlinking the Godavari with the Krishna,” he said.

BJP urges Karnataka CM to sack Ministers over graft allegation

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU

A recent letter to Karnataka Chief Minister D.K. Shivakumar by Congress MLA Ashok Kumar Rai, accusing two engineers of Karnataka Rural Infrastructure Development Limited (KRIDL) of collecting extra charges from contractors stating that it has to be given to the Dakshina Kannada district in-charge Minister and the department Minister, has now taken a serious turn with the BJP urging the Chief Minister to sack these two Ministers.

Addressing a press conference in Bengaluru on Wednesday, Leader of the Opposition in the Assembly R. Ashoka urged the government to immediately dismiss the two Ministers who are allegedly taking

bribes and also hand over the investigation to CBI.

In the letter, Mr. Rai has stated that an extra 7% of money is being collected from contractors in KRIDL, allegedly to be given to these Ministers and that contractors who questioned it are being threatened.

‘Commission raj’

Mr. Ashok alleged that after the Congress came to power, officials were acting in an unruly manner and the government was running a “commission raj.”

“If ₹100 is released, only ₹30 worth of work is done. The remaining 70% goes as commission. When we made the allegation, they asked for documents. Now a Congress MLA himself has spoken about the commission,” he said.



Freshly painted graffiti whitewashed by the JU administration.

Graffiti war continues at JU, administration whitewashes new ones

Senjuti Sengupta
KOLKATA

The battle over graffiti continued at Jadavpur University (JU) as freshly painted drawings by the students were further whitewashed by the administration late on Tuesday night.

Chief Minister Suvendu Adhikari had on August 26 directed the university administration to take action against the “anti-national” graffiti painted on the walls, including the ones hailing Maoist leader Kishenji, demanding freedom of Palestine, Kashmir, and also slogans on “shooting the fascists”.

Following the development, the university administration whitewashed all those graffiti across the main building Aurolindo Bhaban, arts hostel and the open-air theatre.

However, those were repainted, which the students claimed was an attempt to “reclaim” the walls in the university. One of the freshly painted works on Monday quoted Karl Marx as saying “We

have no compassion. And we ask no compassion from you. When our turn comes, we shall not make excuses for the terror”.

A day after, a group of police personnel and officials from Kolkata Municipal Corporation (KMC) reached the university around 12.30 a.m. and whitewashed all the graffiti across all the walls at the campus. These included a portrait of artist Chittaprosad Bhattacharya, painting on climate change, along with the aforementioned statement of Marx, quotes of Ho Chi Minh, Urdu couplets, etc.

V-C’s appeal

Jadavpur University Vice-Chancellor Chiranjib Bhattacharya has called for restraint on wall writings on the campus, appealing to students to express their views on social media. Mr. Bhattacharya said students and teachers should preserve the institution’s long-standing tradition of free thought and expression while keeping the campus clean and peaceful.

Siddaramaiah backs drive to nurture OBC leadership

Nagesh Prabhu
BENGALURU

Former Karnataka Chief Minister Siddaramaiah is backing the formation of Shudra Seva Sanghas in universities and colleges across the State to draw young people from Other Backward Classes (OBCs) into public life and help develop a new generation of political leaders. The initiative assumes significance against the backdrop of the growing visibility of Gen Z-led protests in the country.

Mr. Siddaramaiah recently inaugurated a Shudra Seva Sangha in Bengaluru, and attended the sangha meetings with the objective of involving students belonging to OBCs in social and political activities and nurturing leadership qualities among them.

Pichavaram mangroves valued at ₹2,485 crore: study

K.C. Deepika
BENGALURU

How valuable are mangroves? A recent study of the Pichavaram mangrove ecosystem in Tamil Nadu estimated its total economic value (TEV) at ₹2,485.38 crore, with a per-hectare value of ₹1.83 crore, reflecting the ecological, economic, and social benefits it provides.

The Pichavaram Mangrove Forest is deemed one of the most ecologically significant coastal wetland ecosystems in India and plays a vital role in supporting biodiversity conservation, fisheries productivity, coastal protection, climate regulation,

blue carbon sequestration, and livelihood security for coastal communities.

“Mangrove ecosystems provide a wide range of provisioning, regulating, supporting, and cultural ecosystem services that contribute significantly to ecological sustainability and human well-being. Despite their importance, many ecosystem services remain undervalued in conventional development planning because several ecological benefits are non-market in nature and are not reflected in market transactions,” says the study. “Economic valuation and blue carbon assessment of ecosystem services (ESV) in the Pichavaram



Green gold: Pichavaram Mangrove Forest is a highly significant coastal wetland ecosystem in India. FILE PHOTO

Mangrove Forest”.

The study, by M. Balasubramanian, Associate Professor, Centre for Ecological Economics and Natural Resources, Institute for Social and Economic Change, Bengaluru, was funded by

the Deputy Conservator of Forests, Forest Genetics Division, Coimbatore. It was based on primary and secondary data; primary information was collected from 302 households across five mangrove-de-

pendent villages: MGR Thittu, Kalaigir Nagar, Chinnavaikal, Patriadi, and Mudasalodai.

Carbon sink

“The blue carbon assessment highlights the critical role of the Pichavaram mangroves as a significant natural carbon sink and a valuable climate regulation asset,” says the study.

The analysis further revealed that mangrove sediments constitute an even more substantial carbon reservoir. The average soil organic carbon stock of 251.14 tonnes of carbon per hectare was estimated to generate an economic value of ₹90.24 lakh per hectare, resulting in a total soil

organic carbon value of ₹1,224.63 crore. When vegetation and soil carbon pools are combined, the total blue carbon asset value of the Pichavaram Mangrove Ecosystem is estimated at ₹1,612.40 crore

The study recommends the integration of ecosystem service valuation into coastal development planning and environmental decision-making, the recognition of mangroves as key nature-based solutions for climate adaptation and disaster risk reduction, and the development of blue carbon financing mechanisms, carbon credit programmes, and Payment for Ecosystem Services schemes.



Orthodoxy redux

Religion is oft used as a tool to suppress women in the public sphere

Veteran Islamic cleric Kanthapuram A.P. Aboobacker Musliar’s directive to restrict Muslim women’s participation in public celebrations has unsettled Keralam because it strikes at a fundamental question: women’s right to participate in public life. This is not merely a quarrel over how Muslims should mark Prophet Muhammad’s 1,501st birth anniversary. It is a test of how far religious authority can intrude into the lives of women in a State that takes pride in its progressive social history. Kanthapuram says he is merely reminding followers of established religious norms. His supporters argue Milad celebrations have moved beyond mosques and madrasas into large public events, and that scholars have a duty to caution against such departures. That argument holds no weight. Communities have the right to preserve traditions and regulate religious practices, but they have to conform to the values enshrined in the Constitution. When women are told to remain at home because their presence could cause “chaos”, the issue is no longer about religious observance; it is at variance with constitutional equality and Keralam’s long struggle to expand the space in public life for women disadvantaged by social customs and religious traditions.

The Muslim community is not a monolith. It contains both orthodox and progressive currents. More Muslim women are breaking barriers in education, employment, politics and public life, but that progress is encountering a counter-current of renewed orthodoxy and social control. The CPI(M), Keralam’s main Opposition party and a decades-old ally of the Kanthapuram-led faction of Samastha Kerala Jamiyyathul Ulama, a body of Sunni scholars, has responded sharply. The Congress, which leads the ruling coalition, was largely guarded until Chief Minister V.D. Satheesan rubbished the decree as antediluvian. The Indian Union Muslim League’s silence is harder to defend. A party with an active women’s forum and a woman legislator for the first time in the State Assembly cannot equivocate when women’s right to public participation is open to challenge. Its caution may reflect political pressure over Waqf, *Vande Mataram* and PM-SHRI, or an attempt to improve ties with the Kanthapuram faction amid strained relations with the rival Samastha faction. Whatever the political calculation, silence carries a cost. Religious freedom does not confer on religious authorities the right to regulate women’s freedom of movement, association and degree of participation in society. During Onam, social media were awash with videos of young Muslim girls celebrating the harvest festival. Kanthapuram’s remarks drew criticism from a section of Muslim women on social media. Keralam cannot claim to be progressive while making exceptions for orthodoxy.

Many layers

Farmers need more storage facilities and better distribution networks

Since the 1960s, India has developed a balancing-act habit: between keeping food prices affordably low for consumers and assuring farmers of remunerative prices, with the state’s interventions focused on managing this volatility in the short term. This is also why the government banned onion exports from December 2023 to May 2024, then imposed a \$550/tonne minimum export price and a 40% export duty, reduced the duty to 20% in September 2024, and finally abolished it in April 2025. But erratic weather together with the lack of long-term relief has rendered the act increasingly awkward. From farmers’ point of view, the government often changes its mind after they have made important production-related decisions based on the expected price. On the other hand, during the bounteous *rabi* harvest, onion farmers in Maharashtra, the country’s principal supplier, had argued that the Centre’s procurement price of ₹12.35/kg would not cover the costs of cultivation. The Centre subsequently raised the price to up to ₹26.45/kg, but many farmers – including some who had had to sell at ₹1/kg earlier because of low quality and lack of storage, among other factors – were unable to capture the higher value, exposing the limits of intervening after prices have already collapsed and not reaching all farmers or grades of produce.

While the government has alluded to some price manipulation, the dominant issue remains that it keeps reacting instead of taking proactive measures, including improving storage options, maintaining a less erratic trade policy, moving stock more efficiently between regions, and protecting farmers against price shocks. The abnormal rainfall at the time of harvest and a 5%-7% drop in the *kharif* crop in Maharashtra, together with the well-known challenges associated with storing onions and maintaining large buffers, are simply among the pressures that highlighted the flaw this year. Further, Tamil Nadu’s targeted subsidy, to buy 1,000 tonnes of onions to distribute 1 kg per ration card at ₹35, will impose pressures on the Centre to maintain a steady supply. The move is commendably designed to discourage hoarding while allowing private retail prices to cool down. However, the State must also guard against the pitfalls of distributing onions through a dry-grain PDS network – its economic case could collapse if post-harvest losses, to which onion is more susceptible than, say, wheat or rice, exceed 10%-15% – and if the need arises to persist with the subsidy. Finally, if other States also adopt similar measures, the Central buffer could be quickly exhausted, more so given this year’s high storage losses of around 30%.

On August 25, 2026, in Beijing, National Security Adviser Ajit Doval and China’s Foreign Minister Wang Yi held the 25th round of talks between the Special Representatives (SRs) on the India-China boundary question. That evening’s readouts from both sides were anodyne and notably avoided a phrase that has dominated this discussion for a year: early harvest. A day later, the two sides released an “Eight Points of Outcomes and Consensus”. Point 3 restored and enhanced the phrase: the Expert Group on Boundary Delimitation and the Working Group on Border Management, set up under the Working Mechanism for Consultation and Coordination (WMCC) a year ago, would “respectively advance discussions on an Early and Substantial Harvest of boundary delimitation and Border Management”. Their first task, it adds, is to agree on their own terms of reference, one year after they were constituted, suggesting that whatever is being contemplated remains at an early stage

An uncertain Early Harvest

The phrase “Early and Substantial Harvest” is significant because it is India’s own coinage. When Beijing first proposed settling the Sikkim Sector alone, India’s considered response, around 2019, was a counter-proposal on an “Early and Substantial Harvest” covering the Sikkim Sector together with the entire Middle Sector, with the boundary delineated along the watershed. China rejected the proposal. In subsequent discussions on an “Early Harvest,” China reportedly agreed only to include the Sikkim Sector and some undisputed areas of the Middle Sector – a proposal that was unacceptable to India.

The exact Indian formulation has now resurfaced in a joint document. This could mean that Beijing has accepted India’s terms – which this writer doubts – as that would involve China giving up its claim to approximately 2,450 square kilometres of territory in the Middle Sector, all south of the watershed boundary (Barahoti, Giu-Kaurik, Nilang-Jadhang, Sangcha Malla, and Lapthal). It could equally mean something the Indian side had rejected earlier: an “agreement with holes”, a settlement nominally covering both sectors but confined to stretches where the claims already coincide, leaving the trijunctions and contested pockets of the Middle Sector undefined.

If that is the case, we will have the same asymmetric outcome as with a Sikkim-only settlement – India conceding ground where its position is strong, without any progress in the Eastern and Western Sectors, where China maintains its hardline position, “dong tiao xi rang”, meaning “meaningful adjustments by India in the East and corresponding concessions by China in the West”. It would also jettison a key provision (Article III) of the 2005 Agreement on



Ashok K. Kantha

Former Ambassador of India to China; Subhas Chandra Bose Chair Professor of International Relations at Chanakya University, Bengaluru, and the lead Indian negotiator for the Agreement on Political Parameters and Guiding Principles for Boundary Settlement (2005)

India-China boundary talks suggest movement, but hard questions remain over strategic costs and concessions

Political Parameters and Guiding Principles for the Settlement of the India-China Boundary, which calls for a “package settlement ...covering all sectors of the India-China boundary”, opting instead to bank the easy gains immediately while leaving the hard issues open on China’s terms. The package clause exists precisely because the boundary’s four sectors are strategically interlinked, requiring cross-sector give and take.

No open-and-shut case

The Sikkim Sector is also not the open-and-shut case that some suggest. The two sides agree that the Anglo-Chinese Convention of 1890 is the “basis of the alignment” of the boundary in this sector. However, Article I of the Convention contains two stipulations that are mutually contradictory. Its first sentence makes the watershed crest the boundary, while its second names Mount Gipmochi as the starting point on the Bhutan frontier. Yet, British Indian maps of 1907 and 1913 placed the trijunction not at Gipmochi but roughly 6.5 kilometres to its north, on the true watershed crest. India and Bhutan read the watershed principle as controlling and place the trijunction at Batang La; China seizes on the literal reference to Gipmochi to push the trijunction southwards, onto the Jampheri Ridge. A Sikkim delimitation built on the 1890 text, unless it repudiates Gipmochi, would be read by Beijing as conceding the southern trijunction.

Even a trijunction-reserved settlement would strip India of the standing to counsel Bhutan against a bilateral deal, having itself settled out of turn nearby. China’s “package proposal” to Bhutan – relinquishing roughly 495 sq km of claims in the north in exchange for Bhutan ceding about 269 sq km in the northwest, including the Doklam Plateau – would gain fresh momentum, deepening China’s presence in the Chumbi Valley and opening a path to the Jampheri Ridge, from which the entire Siliguri Corridor, India’s sole overland link to its northeastern States, would come under direct observation. This is not hypothetical: since the 2017 Doklam standoff, China has spent years building roads, villages, and military facilities across western Bhutan, gaining de facto control over Doklam.

A genuine “Early and Substantial Harvest” requires three things. First, delineation must proceed on the highest-watershed principle across the entire stretch in both sectors, rather than selectively along segments where the two positions already converge, which would serve no purpose for India. Second, trijunction points, at Batang La and any comparable third-country-adjacent points in the Middle Sector, must be explicitly excluded from the Expert Group’s mandate and settled only in consultation with the country concerned, as stipulated in the 2012 Common Understanding between the two SRs. However, unless the highest-watershed principle is accepted, silence

Reducing India’s exposure to U.S. tariff risks



Himanshu Jaiswal

Consultant at the Centre for Social and Economic Progress, New Delhi

The Lindsey O. Graham Act puts India under pressure, but export diversification and domestic reforms can cushion shocks

the strategy has helped secure supplies, it carries diplomatic costs, particularly in managing ties with the United States, which seeks to strongly discourage these imports. The U.S. Russia Sanctions Act reflects this pressure.

On July 24, before the bill’s introduction, the U.S. imposed forced-labour tariffs on 60 countries, including India, under Section 301 of the Trade Act of 1974, imposing an additional 10% tariff, a replacement of the expired 10% duty under Section 122, on India. If the Russia Sanctions Act becomes law, India’s cumulative tariff could reach 110%, making it one of the most heavily tariffed countries. Such high tariffs could affect India’s price competitiveness in the U.S., a major export market, leading to economic losses. China’s cumulative tariff could reach 112.5%, as both countries are major importers of Russian crude.

Trade simulations and results

To analyse the trade dynamics and possible way forward for India, two global trade simulations were conducted using the GTAP dataset and model, a global general equilibrium model that captures global linkages and country-level shocks. The first (sanction scenario) models a 110% U.S. tariff on India, with other countries facing forced-labour tariffs and China facing 112.5%. The second (diversification scenario) applies the same tariffs while India pursues export diversification, proxied by a full India-European Union free trade agreement (FTA).

The simulation results suggest that the proposed U.S. sanctions could have adverse consequences for the Indian economy. Under the sanction scenario, India’s welfare declines by nearly \$47 billion, while GDP, output, domestic demand, exports, and imports all contract. Aggregate exports fall by 5.1% and imports by 5.2%, reflecting disrupted trade flows and weaker

on the trijunction will, on the ground, be filled in Beijing’s favour in Bhutan. Third, the terms of reference for the Expert Group must extend India’s 2019 proposal in good faith, rather than dilute it beyond recognition.

Several questions about these negotiations remain unanswered. The Chinese readout of August 25 reiterates a commitment to a “package” settlement, but how will that commitment be reconciled with a piecemeal approach to settlement? How is the setting up of an Expert Group on Delimitation consistent with the instructions given to the SRs in Article X of the 2005 Agreement, which require them to “continue consultations in an earnest manner with the objective of arriving at an agreed framework for a boundary settlement, which will provide the basis for the delineation and demarcation of the India-China boundary to be subsequently undertaken by civil and military officials and surveyors of the two sides”? There is no agreed framework yet, but it is proposed to commence the process of “delimitation”, a term that the Chinese use interchangeably with “demarcation”. Indeed, the 2005 Agreement does not use the term “delimitation” at all. Will the SRs earnestly pursue negotiations on the “agreed framework”, or will they, in effect, leave it in abeyance while officials grapple with a partial delimitation exercise without such a framework? The other elements of the Eight Points – additional meeting points and hotlines for the General Level Mechanisms in the Eastern and Middle Sectors, continued pilgrimage and border trade, and a September meeting on trans-border rivers – are useful, incremental confidence-building measures. But they belong to a different track from boundary settlement and should not be conflated in public discussion.

The Eight Points are silent on the Medog County project on the Yarlung Tsangpo River, while referring to both sides agreeing to “maintain communication on (trans-border river) issues, including hydrological data sharing and renewal of the relevant MoUs”, without reporting any progress. The September meeting should convey India’s concerns about the project – the world’s largest hydropower plant – being built close to the border in the Eastern Sector, in a highly earthquake-prone zone, a risk underscored by the flash floods in Nepal on August 26.

Avoid optics

Two points bear reiteration. First, the 2005 agreement – the only substantive outcome of 23 years of SR talks – must not be diluted; China has sought to reinterpret and undermine it since its conclusion. Second, Indian negotiators must guard against the temptation to project contrived progress. Diplomacy that trades long-term strategic interests for short-term optics is self-defeating.

economic activity. The results indicate that a prolonged tariff-based confrontation with the U.S. could impose substantial costs on India’s growth and trade performance.

The picture changes considerably when India responds through export diversification. With a functional India-EU FTA, the economy turns around despite the same tariff environment. Welfare improves by \$26.3 billion, GDP turns positive, and sectoral output and domestic demand recover by around 1%. Aggregate exports increase by 3.1%, while imports rise by a moderate 2.6%, indicating stronger production and trade integration with alternative markets.

The findings suggest that even if India continues procuring crude from Russia to strengthen its energy security, the adverse economic effects of U.S. tariffs can be mitigated to a large extent through export diversification. The India-EU FTA, used here as a proxy for diversification, demonstrates that India must increasingly look beyond the U.S. and expand its presence in alternative markets, even as the U.S. remains one of its largest export destinations.

The strategy to pursue

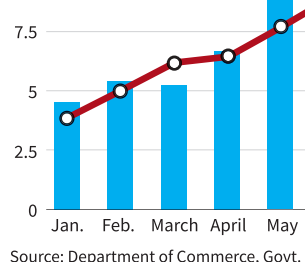
However, diversification is not a panacea. It depends on the ability of other markets to absorb additional Indian exports. Without adequate external demand, diversification may remain limited.

Therefore, export diversification must be complemented by sustained domestic reforms, including trade facilitation, removal of non-tariff barriers, improved logistics and standards, and movement up the goods quality ladder. Such a strategy would not only enhance India’s resilience to future geopolitical shocks but also strengthen its long-term export competitiveness.

The views expressed are personal

India’s crude import from Russia

Quantity (MMT)
Share in total crude imports (%)



Source: Department of Commerce, Govt. of India

Impact of tariffs and export diversification

	Sanction scenario	Diversification scenario
Welfare (\$ billion)	-46.6	26.3
Change in GDP (%)	-0.02	0.01
Sectoral output (%)	-1.9	1.2
Domestic demand (%)	-1.8	1
Aggregate export (%)	-5.1	3.1
Aggregate import (%)	-5.2	2.6

Source: Writer’s analysis using GTAP

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

The north-south lens

The main article (Editorial page, September 2) risks turning a complex federal question into a simplistic north-versus-south narrative. India’s political influence has never been determined by geography alone; it reflects population, electoral mandates, governance, economic contribution and the ability of States to build national

coalitions. The southern States continue to exercise considerable political, economic and institutional influence, while several leaders from the region have shaped national policy. Portraying elected southern governments as “suppliant” or “submissive” is subjective and needlessly polarising. Delimitation deserves rigorous constitutional

debate, but framing it primarily as northern domination may deepen regional divisions rather than strengthen India’s federal compact.
Venkat Parthasarathy,
Hyderabad

Austerity call

The call to citizens of the country to avoid unnecessary foreign travel and destination weddings

abroad to conserve foreign exchange would carry greater weight if accompanied by restraint from those at the top. Overseas travel by national leaders may often be necessary in the public interest, but when citizens are asked to limit their foreign expenditure, similar prudence from those in positions of authority would strengthen the message.

Leadership is not only about asking citizens to sacrifice, but also about setting an example.
Tharcus S. Fernando,
Chennai

Football’s great artist

Legend Lionel Messi’s retirement from international football marks the end of one of modern sport’s most extraordinary chapters. For two decades,

he transformed football into an art form, carrying Argentina’s expectations through years of heartbreak and criticism. He leaves the international stage not only as a statistical giant, but also as a symbol of humility, grace and vision.
R. Sivakumar,
Chennai

Letters emailed to letters@thehindu.co.in must carry the postal address.

River-linking is not the solution

The Union Minister for Home Affairs Amit Shah's speech at the Southern Zonal Council's meeting last month in Mamallapuram has provided a few takeaways on the contentious issue of water sharing. His emphasis on the need for an early resolution of water-related issues in the southern region appears well meaning but it is easier said than done. He had also talked about linking major rivers from the Brahmaputra to the Godavari and the Cauvery, an option that, according to Mr. Shah, can ensure that India faces no water shortage for 100 years.

However, water issues are not that easy to solve. This is evident from the Centre's response to Tamil Nadu's demand for the constitution of a tribunal to adjudicate the Pennaiyar river water dispute. Aggrieved over the "violation" of the 1892 inter-State agreement by Karnataka, Tamil Nadu, in November 2019, requested the Centre to establish a tribunal. It had also moved the Supreme Court with the same demand. Since then, two negotiation committees have been formed and 11 meetings held. Eventually, the top court, this February, directed the Centre to form the tribunal within a month and, later, extended the deadline by six months.

Still, the adjudicatory body is yet to be put in place. Meanwhile, the Centre asked the court whether the Pennaiyar dispute could be referred to the Mahadayi Water Dispute Tribunal instead of constituting a new tribunal. This suggestion defies logic as there is nothing in common between the two



T. Ramakrishnan

disputes. Moreover, the Interstate River Water Disputes Act, 1956 does not permit it. This suggestion in the Pennaiyar case gives the impression that the Centre is not keen on expeditiously implementing a judicial verdict in an inter-State river dispute. To cite one more example, the Central government has not yet replied to Tamil Nadu's demand, in March this year, to constitute a tribunal on the Mekedatu dam project proposed by Karnataka.

A complex problem
Given this background, one need not delve much into the complications that would entail by the inter-linking of rivers. Proponents of river linking, including Tamil Nadu, have been saying that the idea is not to disturb the natural flow of any river but to divert a portion of the surplus water. Many experts are not convinced about this argument as they are worried that once the linking is allowed, regions that benefit may become vociferous in demanding water even in times of distress, eventually depriving original beneficiaries of their quota. This is apart from the concerns over the possible adverse consequences on ecology. In fact, Keralam has been stoutly opposing the Pamba-Achankovil-Vaippar link proposal, which, if implemented, the State says, will affect the Vembanad wetland system, where the Pamba and Achankovil rivers drain. However, the National Water Development Agency says that it has accounted for improving the flow of rivers in lean periods.

In the last 130-odd years, the country has seen only a handful of inter-basin transfer projects, most of which are in south India

Mullaperiyar dam, the Parambikulam-Aliyar project, the Krishna Water Supply Project, and the Indira Gandhi Canal Project are regarded as successful examples of inter-basin transfer of river waters.

After the Bharatiya Janata Party's return to power in 2014, the Union government formed a Special Committee for Interlinking of Rivers, which has held over two dozen meetings since then. Needless to say, there has not been much headway.

However, in 2024, Prime Minister Narendra Modi laid the foundation stone for the ₹44,000 crore Ken-Betwa Link Project. This has now led to agitations by the tribal populations in Chhatarpur.

What the governments, both at the Centre and in States, and civil society should focus on is demand side management, instead of perpetually looking for supply side interventions. With land becoming scarcely available and resistance growing among people when it comes to land acquisition, the days of implementing mega irrigation projects are almost over. The priority has to be towards conserving what is available and using it judiciously. A massive programme of sensitising and incentivising farmers on the optimal use of water has to be launched. Indiscriminate extraction of groundwater, facilitated by schemes of free electricity for agriculture in many States, is paving the way for ecological disaster and has to be curbed immediately. Unless water conservation becomes the mantra of all the stakeholders and is practised genuinely, disputes will be the norm.

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Mental health must anchor public health

India stands at a defining moment in its journey towards the vision of Viksit Bharat 2047. Under the Healthcare for All pillar, the government has rightly prioritised strengthening Ayushman Bharat, expanding primary healthcare, reducing out-of-pocket expenditure, and promoting preventive care. Yet there is one element that cuts across all these ambitions and determines their success: mental health.

Mental health is not a niche concern. It influences educational attainment, workforce participation, social cohesion, and physical health outcomes. A healthier and more productive India cannot be built without placing mental well-being at the centre of public health.

Major implications
The scale of the challenge is substantial. Mental illness affects one in seven Indians, with nearly 200 million people living with a diagnosable mental health condition. The contribution of mental disorders to India's total disease burden has doubled over the past three decades. Yet the national treatment gap remains 84.5%, meaning that more than four out of five people who need care do not receive it. The reasons are well known. India has only 0.3 psychiatrists per 1,00,000 population, alongside significant shortages in clinical psychologists, psychiatric social workers, and psychiatric nurses. These shortages are the result of decades during which mental health received insufficient attention, both in India and globally.

Mental disorders significantly increase the risk



Indu Bhushan

Founding CEO of India's National Health Authority and Ayushman Bharat



Anisha Padukone

CEO of The Live Love Laugh Foundation

of chronic diseases, while chronic diseases in turn increase the risk of mental illness. More than 60% of people attending primary care facilities have a diagnosable mental disorder. Rates of anxiety and depression are substantially higher among people living with diabetes, hypertension, tuberculosis, and HIV/AIDS. Ignoring mental health, therefore, undermines efforts to control non-communicable diseases and reduce healthcare expenditure.

The economic implications are equally compelling. A 2025 modelling study by researchers from PGIMER and NIMHANS estimated that integrating universal depression screening into India's primary healthcare system could generate net savings of ₹291 billion to ₹482 billion annually, equivalent to as much as 0.32% of GDP. Mental health is not a social welfare issue alone – it is also a human capital investment and an economic growth strategy.

The encouraging news is that India has already built many of the foundations required for transformation. More than 1.73 lakh sub-centres and primary health centres have been converted into Ayushman Bharat Arogya Mandirs, with mental healthcare included among the essential service packages. The District Mental Health Programme now covers more than 90% of districts. Tele-MANAS, launched in 2022, has expanded across all States and Union Territories.

Three main priorities
The task now is not to start from scratch. It is to build on this foundation at scale. First, one must empower

frontline health workers to become the backbone of community mental healthcare. India's one million ASHA workers represent the world's largest community health workforce. Evidence from Madhya Pradesh and other States demonstrates that, with appropriate training and supervision, ASHAs can successfully identify, support, and refer individuals with common mental disorders. Expanding this model through validated screening tools, digital learning platforms, and performance-linked incentives could expand access to care.

Second, India must invest more systematically in community-based care. Models such as Zimbabwe's Friendship Bench, Atmiyata in India, and programmes implemented by The Live Love Laugh Foundation demonstrate that trained community workers can bridge the gap between awareness and treatment, particularly in rural and underserved populations. These approaches improve access and reduce costs, and deserve wider adoption and funding. Third, the country must fully realise the promise of financial protection. Extending outpatient mental health benefits under the Pradhan Mantri Jan Arogya Yojana and strengthening the implementation of insurance parity as per the Mental Healthcare Act, 2017, would make mental healthcare affordable for millions who currently go without care.

If India is to become a truly developed nation by 2047, mental health must move from the margins of public policy to its centre.

If India is to become a truly developed nation by 2047, mental health must move from the margins of public policy to its centre

Decoding Russia's reliance on Indian petroleum products

Ukraine's recent relentless attacks on Russia's oil refineries has led the country to rely on India for petroleum imports

DATA POINT

Nitika Francis

Recent Ukrainian attacks on Russia's oil refineries has resulted in the latter importing refined petroleum products from India in significant quantities for the first time, at least since the Russia-Ukraine war started in February 2022.

As per multiple media reports, including one by the *Press Trust of India*, Indian refiners sent about one million barrels over the last two months, alongside Turkey and Morocco. Russia's import of petroleum products from India has remained negligible in the past, accounting for less than one per cent of India's petroleum exports. The bulk of exports went to countries like the Netherlands, Australia and the UAE (**Chart 1**).

Though the Indian government's export and import-related data for the last two months is yet to be released, reports have confirmed that the country's export of refined petroleum products to Russia has sharply increased in the last two months. This has tilted the huge imbalance that existed between the two countries in oil trade, albeit marginally. India continues to remain hugely dependent on Russia for crude.

One-fourth of India's petroleum imports since January 2022 were from Russia and this number remained high before U.S. President Donald Trump imposed additional tariffs on India in October 2025 for buying crude from Russia.

Though this resulted in India sharply cutting down its crude import from Russia, the imports resumed in full swing soon after. In fact, after the U.S. and Israel launched a war with Iran in February this year, the former did a U-turn in its stance and tacitly encouraged Russian crude supplies into the market to negate the impact of Iran's blockade in the Strait of Hormuz.

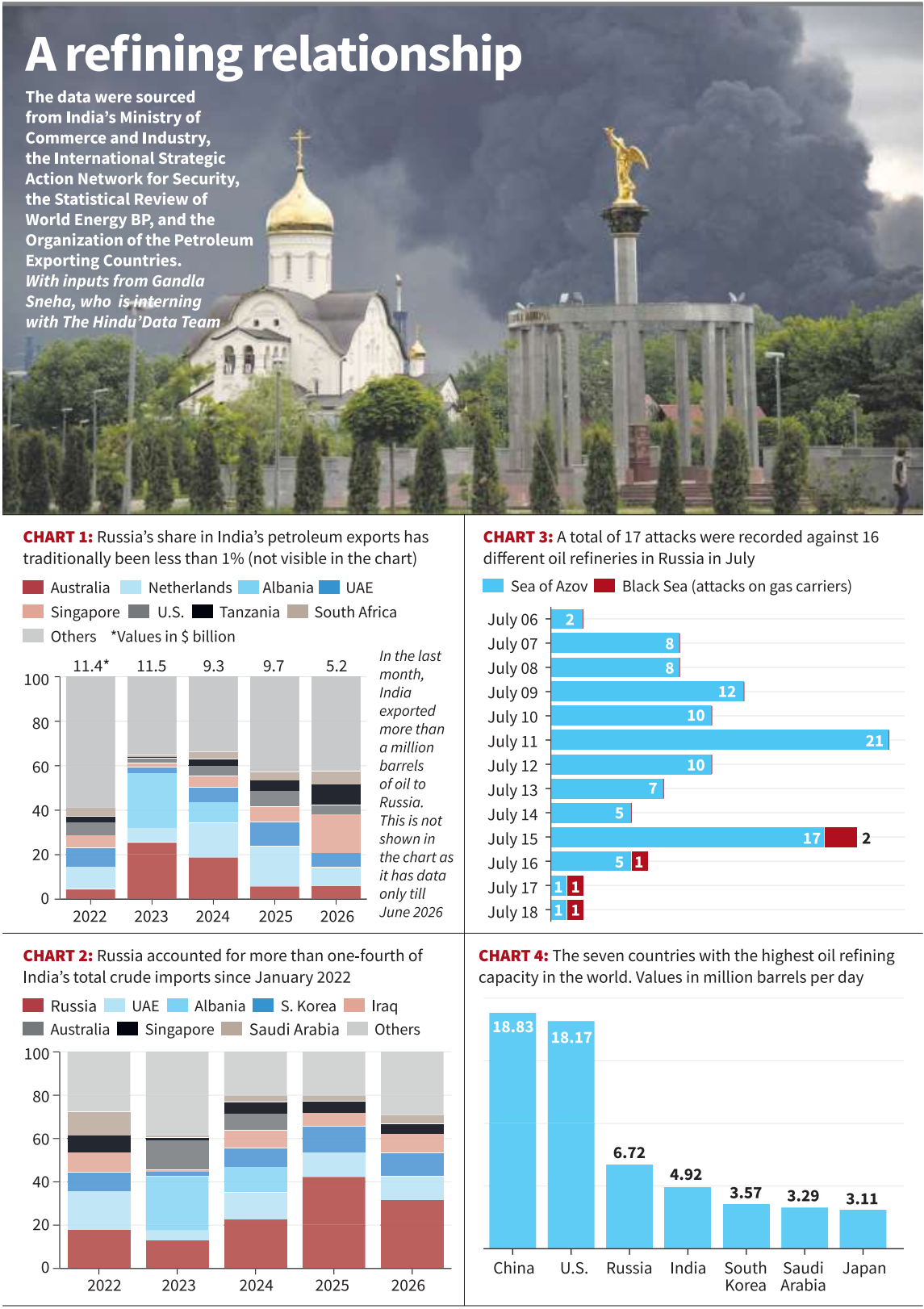
Chart 2 shows how Russia accounted for nearly one-third (31.6%) of India's crude imports as of June 2026. India imported \$531 million worth of crude from Russia in June 2026, which is roughly double that of its import from the country in January 2022, a month before Russia's invasion of Ukraine.

Amid Ukraine's continued targeting of Russia's oil refining infrastructure, the Russian Federation's Deputy Prime Minister Alexander Novak said in July that the country would begin importing oil products to help stabilise the domestic market.

Consistent attacks

According to the International Strategic Action Network for Security, there were at least 17 attacks on 16 different oil refineries in Russia. Eight attacks were targeted at oil depots and oil pumping stations in July (**Chart 3**). Though reliable data on similar attacks in August are not available yet, they seem to have continued at the same rate, resulting in petrol and diesel shortages.

Data from the Organization of the Petroleum Exporting Countries (OPEC) show that Russia's refinery crude throughput went from about 5.18 million barrels per day in Q12026 (January to March) in the beginning of the year, to about 3.88 million barrels per day in Q32026. The attacks also seem to have contributed to a surge in crude exports from Russia, as unplanned refinery outages diverted higher volumes of crude to the export market. India, which ranks fourth in oil-refining capacity in the world, has utilised Russia's sudden demand to export refined petroleum products, mainly from private refineries (**Chart 4**). Considering the time it would take for Russia to bring its refining capacity back to its earlier capacity, the surge in exports could continue, which will help India in easing its pressure on foreign exchange in the coming months.



FROM THE ARCHIVES

The *Hindu*.

FIFTY YEARS AGO SEPTEMBER 3, 1976

Tip-off leads to underground vault

Madras, September 2: Sixteen exquisite bronze idols and 17 puja utensils all valued at Rs. one crore have been recovered from an underground vault in the ancient Kalyanasundarar Temple in Nallur, Papanasam taluk in Thanjavur district. The temple is under the control of the Tiruvaduthurai Adheenam.

Officials of the Hindu Religious and Charitable Endowments Department and State Directorate of Archaeology, led by Dr. R. Nagaswami, Director of Archaeology, acting on a hint thrown by the temple executive searched and found the vault. A representative of the Tiruvaduthurai Adheenam was present during the search. The Math's records indicate that these valuable images and jewels had been deposited in the safe vault in 1942.

These rare pieces of art were retrieved earlier this week after securing an order from the State Government to rummage the underground cell in the temple precincts.

Apart from the discovery of the valuable pieces from the subterranean chamber, this probe has given a clue to the traditional method of safeguarding precious idols and ornaments of a temple and the care bestowed on preservation of art forms.

A HUNDRED YEARS AGO SEPTEMBER 3, 1926

Slavery in Burma frontier

Rangoon, September 2: *The Rangoon Gazette* says that the successful emancipation of slaves in Hukawng valley last season will, it is said, be followed this cold season by an expedition to that part of unadministered territory between Malikha and Nmaikha rivers, north of their junction to the Irrawaddy river and locally known as the triangle where the same system of slavery as existed in Hukawng valley still prevails. The triangles though not as extensive a territory as Hukawng valley, is more densely populated and the number of slaves to be liberated will be more numerous. It is expected that Mr. J.T.O. Barnard, Deputy Commissioner, Burma, Frontier Service, who was principally responsible for the arrangements for the emancipation of the slaves in the Hukawng valley will be placed on this duty and in charge of the expedition. *The Gazette's* statement is yet unconfirmed.

Text & Context

THE HINDU

NEWS IN NUMBERS

Amount mobilised by banks in deposits from Indian diaspora

127.23 in \$ billion. India attracted a whopping USD 127.23 billion in Foreign Currency Non-Resident (FCNR-B) deposits under the Reserve Bank's special USD-INR forex swap facility till August 31, the closing date. The RBI's special USD-INR forex swap facility was launched on June 8, 2026. PTI

Length of Manipur's border with Myanmar that has been fenced

55 in kilometres. Manipur Home Minister Govindas Konhoujam on Wednesday said that nearly 55 km out of 398 km of the State's international border with Myanmar has been fenced. Mr. Konhoujam was responding to a calling attention motion raised by Congress MLA K. Ranjit Singh on the "reported proposal for a land swap deal between India and Myanmar". PTI

Number of dengue cases recorded in Delhi till August 29

311 As many as 311 cases of dengue, 119 of malaria and 22 of chikungunya have been recorded in Delhi till August 29 this year, while no death has been reported due to any of the diseases. Delhi recorded its highest monthly tally of dengue cases this year in August, with 90 infections reported during the month, a Municipal Corporation of Delhi report says. PTI

Number of special trains operated during Onam season this year

180 As many as 180 special train services were operated in the Thiruvananthapuram Division during the Onam festive season this year, carrying an additional 2,45,823 passengers, railway officials said here on Wednesday. The division recorded an overall punctuality of 94.67% in August this year, compared to 91% during the same month last year. PTI

Applications received for police recruitment in Himachal Pradesh

98 in thousands. The State Public Service Commission has received over 98,000 applications for police constable recruitment till September 1, 2026, Himachal Pradesh CM Sukhvinder Singh Sukhu told the Assembly on Wednesday. He said the September 5 deadline for application would not be extended. PTI

COMPILED BY THE HINDU DATA TEAM

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Constitutional faultlines in FCRA Bill

The FCRA Amendment Bill, 2026 provides for a 'Designated Authority' to oversee the management and disposal of foreign contributions and assets when an organisation's FCRA certificate is cancelled or ceases to exist; raising questions about the extent of State intervention and the need for sufficient safeguards against overreach

LETTER & SPIRIT

Thajaswini C.B.
Siddharth Dev Prasad

It is hard to deny that the state has a legitimate concern in regulating foreign contributions in India, as foreign donations raise issues concerning national security, transparency in democracy, and public accountability. For decades, the Foreign Contribution (Regulation) Act has been the instrument through which this interest has been pursued. However, the Foreign Contribution (Regulation) Amendment Bill, 2026 raises a different question altogether. It goes beyond regulating foreign contributions, to the extent to which the state may intervene in assets and institutional activities associated with them.

The fundamental issue, therefore, is not a debate between civil society and national security. It is about where the State, in pursuit of its legitimate regulatory goal, may cross the boundary from regulating foreign contributions to exercising undue executive control over the institutions that receive them.

The Bill's most important aspect is a statutory framework for the vesting, supervision, management and disposal of foreign contributions and assets through a 'Designated Authority'. Where an organisation's FCRA certificate is cancelled, surrendered or ceases to exist, including due to non-renewal, the Central government may appoint an authority to which the foreign contribution and assets created from it may vest provisionally. The measure is framed as an accountability mechanism to prevent the diversion or abuse of such properties.

Expansion of statutory consequences However, the constitutional difficulty lies elsewhere.

The FCRA has always empowered the state to scrutinise foreign funding. If there are any violations in this regard, registrations can be withdrawn,



Opposition MPs protest in New Delhi on April 1, demanding the withdrawal of the FCRA Amendment Bill.

cancellation can follow continuing non-compliance, and penalties can attach to the diversion or misappropriation of foreign contributions. The Bill, however, represents a significant expansion of the statutory consequences that can follow the loss of FCRA registration. Importantly, the existing FCRA law already contains a provision for vesting assets created from foreign funds upon cancellation. What is new is the detailed statutory framework for their provisional vesting, possession, management, restoration and ultimately, permanent vesting and disposal.

In case of cancellation, surrender, or cessation of registration, the government may, through the Designated Authority, take possession of and manage assets created from foreign contributions and, where considered necessary or expedient in the public interest, undertake the management of the concerned organisation's activities. This is not merely a change in administrative policy; it raises a constitutional question about the extent to which a statute regulating foreign contributions may permit executive authorities to assume possession and, in specified circumstances, management of institutional assets and activities.

Even if the dichotomy between ownership and custody may have some legal relevance, its practical consequences are not. An entity whose success is dependent on the continuity of management will place greater emphasis on control than ownership. Ownership may remain formally undisturbed, but a change in management control fundamentally alters the relationship between the institution and the state. A hospital, school or laboratory is not made effective by ownership alone; it depends on its independence to administer, for charitable ends, what it owns.

Evaluation of proportionality

This is where the doctrine of constitutional proportionality may be relevant. The Supreme Court has repeatedly held that even where the state pursues a legitimate objective, the means it adopts must bear a reasonable connection to that objective and must maintain an appropriate balance between the public purpose and the burden imposed on rights. The amendment raises difficult questions when measured against the said rationale. If the consequence of losing FCRA registration is the provisional vesting of assets in, and potentially the

management of institutional activities by a government-appointed authority, the safeguards attending that transfer must be commensurately robust.

Therefore, the Bill warrants scrutiny of the extent of the discretion delegated to the executive, the safeguards governing its exercise and the standards applicable to decisions concerning possession, management, and permanent vesting. The Bill provides for the restoration of assets when registration is obtained, renewed, or restored within the prescribed period, as well as mechanisms for revision and judicial appeal. The constitutional question is whether these safeguards are sufficiently clear, timely and effective.

This concern becomes more significant against the broader regulatory landscape. Over the past decade, thousands of FCRA registrations have ceased to operate for reasons ranging from non-renewal to alleged statutory violations. While many regulatory actions may be justified, the Bill may increase the consequences arising from the cessation of registration. What might previously have been limited to the loss of eligibility to receive foreign funds could, under the proposed framework, extend to provisional management and, if registration is not restored within the prescribed period, permanent vesting and disposal of assets.

None of this suggests that the government lacks the authority to strengthen financial oversight or ensure that funds from abroad are used for lawful and proper ends. But in a constitutional order, any regime that reaches into the management of civil society's institutional infrastructure must operate within clear legislative standards.

Ultimately, the constitutional question posed by the FCRA Amendment Bill is not whether foreign contributions should be regulated, but how far the state may go in regulating institutions and their assets. (Thajaswini C.B. is an advocate practising before the Supreme Court, Madras and Delhi High Courts. Siddharth Dev Prasad is a 4th year law student at Gujarat National Law University.)

THE GIST

The FCRA has always empowered the state to scrutinise foreign funding. The amendment Bill, however, represents a significant expansion of the statutory consequences that can follow the loss of FCRA registration.

Therefore, the Bill warrants scrutiny of the extent of the discretion delegated to the executive, the safeguards governing its exercise and the standards applicable to decisions concerning possession, management, and permanent vesting.

Can jurists be appointed as Supreme Court judges?

Why has the provision allowing distinguished jurists to be appointed as SC judges remained unused?

Aaratrika Bhaumik

The story so far:

Supreme Court judge Justice Ujjal Bhuyan on Sunday questioned why a constitutional provision allowing a "distinguished jurist" to be appointed as a judge of the Supreme Court has remained unused for more than 76 years. Addressing the 13th convocation of National Law University, Delhi's LL.M. programme, Justice Bhuyan pointed out that Article 124(3) of the Constitution permits the appointment of a person who, in the President's opinion, is a "distinguished jurist" as a Supreme Court judge. However, no legal academic has so far been elevated to the top court under this provision.

What does the Constitution stipulate?

Article 124(3) of the Constitution lays down three routes through which a

person may qualify for appointment as a Supreme Court judge – a person must have served as a High Court judge for at least five years, practised as an advocate of a High Court for at least 10 years, or be, in the opinion of the President, a "distinguished jurist".

The provision, however, does not define who qualifies as a "distinguished jurist" or prescribe any minimum period of professional experience for such a person. Its inclusion as a separate category nevertheless indicates that the framers contemplated a route to the Supreme Court beyond the conventional pathways of judicial service and legal practice, potentially opening the door to eminent legal scholars and academics.

What do Constituent Assembly debates reflect?

The "distinguished jurist" category was added to the list of persons eligible for

appointment to the Supreme Court in the draft Constitution. The Constituent Assembly debates reflect that this was intended to bring diversity in professional backgrounds among those appointed to the Bench of the Supreme Court.

Moving the amendment on May 24, 1949, Constituent Assembly member H.V. Kamath said it sought "to open a wider field of choice" for Supreme Court appointments. He noted that persons with "outstanding legal and juristic learning" were "not necessarily confined to judges or advocates", pointing to the selection of judges of the International Court of Justice on similar terms.

The Constituent Assembly debates also referred to the appointment of Felix Frankfurter to the U.S. Supreme Court. In 1939, President Franklin D. Roosevelt appointed Frankfurter, who had been a professor at Harvard Law School for 25 years, as an Associate Justice of the U.S.

Supreme Court. Justice Frankfurter went on to become a noted advocate of the doctrine of judicial restraint – the principle that courts should respect the domain of the elected legislature and the executive, and exercise restraint in interfering with their decisions.

Assembly member M. Ananthasayanam Ayyangar cited Justice Frankfurter's appointment as a "novel experiment" that had worked well, noting that legal expertise was not confined to practising lawyers or judges.

Can a 'distinguished jurist' be appointed as a High Court judge?

The Constituent Assembly had also considered allowing "distinguished jurists" to be appointed as High Court judges. On June 7, 1949, Professor Shibban Lal Saksena moved an amendment proposing their inclusion among those eligible for appointment to a High Court. The proposal, however, was not accepted.

Nearly three decades later, the Constitution (Forty-second Amendment) Act, 1976, enacted during the Emergency, amended Article 217, which lays down the qualifications for appointment as a High Court judge. The amendment allowed a person who was, in the opinion of the President, a "distinguished jurist" to be appointed to a High Court. The provision came into force in January 1977 but was omitted by the Constitution (Forty-fourth

Amendment) Act, 1978.

What limits the use of this provision?

Despite being part of the Constitution since its inception, the provision has never been invoked. Supreme Court judges have overwhelmingly been appointed from among High Court judges, with only 11 advocates directly elevated from the Bar.

The appointment process itself may also help explain why the provision has remained unused, since a jurist would first have to be recommended by the Supreme Court Collegium. Legal scholar Upendra Baxi, whose possible appointment to the court never materialised, described the provision as a "dead issue" in a 2015 interview with LiveLaw.

Another concern is that legal academics may lack courtroom and procedural experience. However, full-time law teachers themselves face restrictions on practising as advocates. Under Rule 49 of the Bar Council of India Rules, an advocate who takes up full-time salaried employment must cease to practise while such employment continues. In 2019, the Consortium of National Law Universities sought a relaxation of this restriction to allow full-time faculty to practise in courts and bridge the divide between "law in books" and "law in action".

BOOK EXTRACT



Fisherwomen cast a large traditional fishing net into the Indravati river on the outskirts of Jagdalpur in Bastar district, Chhattisgarh. PTI

A colonial gaze: how the British imagined Bastar and its people

Colonial accounts portrayed Bastar as a primitive, isolated woodland whose inhabitants were ‘rude and barbarous,’ while a flawed census produced wildly unreliable population figures and recorded a plethora of colourful yet inaccurate professions

Shantanu Nandan Sharma

For years, Bastar remained an enigma to the British, who erroneously and conveniently dismissed it as a mysterious woodland inhabited by cannibals, painting it as an island of primitiveness amidst civilisations. In his enthusiasm to author a two-volume work on India, East India Company official Henry Harpur Spry went so far as to describe the people of Bastar as those who ‘sacrifice and eat their fellow creatures’.

Spread of misinformation
Consider this: Spry never set foot in Bastar, relying instead on hearsay from Company officers like Captain Crawford of the Bengal Artillery, who oversaw Chhattisgarh. Spry’s armchair account reads more like lengthy chatter rather than a valuable historical document. Further, there is no evidence to suggest that Crawford himself had any first-hand experience in Bastar. It is important to put it on record that Spry also made a glaring mistake on Bastar when he called its Rajput Raja a Gond. This mistake was possibly carried over from the past. While translating the *Tarikh-i-Firishta*, a medieval Persian history of the Deccan with intriguing references to the Bastar of 1610-11, John Briggs added an asterisk to the Bastar raja, mistakenly labelling him as a Gond chief.

The isolation of Bastar fostered the spread of misinformation. A report from the East India Company in 1812, for

example, provided a skewed perspective of the area and the people therein. The inhabitants were described as ‘rude and barbarous’, yet they were paradoxically praised for the staunch defence of their ‘ancient rightful inheritance’ - the lowlands. The report says that they, ‘although rude and barbarous, may yet be denominated warlike, as they have always distinguished themselves bold, persevering champions of the great law of nature’.

It further adds: ‘Being driven to their wild unwholesome fastness, among the mountains, they frequently descend in harvest time, into the lowlands, to dispute the produce of their ancient rightful inheritance with their present possessors...’ Clearly, the report’s author had not visited the territory.

Counting the people
The first attempt to quantify Bastar’s population came on November 5, 1866 during a census in the Central Provinces. This inaugural headcount yielded a figure of 2,69,684. However, the census was plagued by significant anomalies. The administration faced a dilemma when the next census in 1872 showed an inexplicable 70 per cent drop in the population, bringing the total down to 78,856. The breakdown of this figure included 29,060 Hindus, 1,704 Muslims, and a substantial category of 48,092 classified as ‘others’.

A deadly combination of cholera and famine ravaged central India in 1869, undoubtedly impacting Bastar. However,

this alone would not explain the population plunge – a staggering 1,90,828 residents vanishing in just six years. The numbers reeked of error.

J.W. Neill, officiating secretary to the Central Provinces’ chief commissioner, echoed these concerns in his report on the 1872 census. He pointed out glaring inconsistencies: The 1866 Bastar figures were likely mere estimates based on area, while the 1872 census, despite claiming a more rigorous method, also appeared flawed, as in many villages ‘the children were not enumerated’. The report quotes comments from the deputy commissioner of Upper Godavari district, under whose jurisdiction Bastar fell for census purposes.

Neill’s report continued to expose the flaws of the 1872 census in Bastar. While forms and instructions reached the raja, ‘there is no means of knowing whether houses were numbered or lists of inhabitants taken previous to the night of the Census’. Some areas, such as Jagdalpur, Bhopalpatnam and Bijapur, showed decent efforts, but the rest carried errors.

Most alarmingly, children under twelve were entirely omitted. While the Central Provinces overall saw a modest increase (from 9.06 million to 9.25 million), Bastar’s dramatic decline remained an enigma. In the census exercise of early British days, a headcount was conducted on a single day.

The 1872 census wasn’t just plagued by regional discrepancies; there were some structural errors too. The sheer number

of categories (caste, occupation, race, religion, remarks, etc. – a whopping nineteen) gave printers nightmares. Worse yet, a lack of training on open-ended questions led to a plethora of colourful yet inaccurate professions across the Central Provinces. Imagine finding entries like ‘con man’, ‘pimp’, ‘prostitute’, ‘idiot’, and ‘thief’ – a reflection more on the confusion of the enumerators than the reality of the population.

Neill’s report candidly highlighted the hilarious mishaps. He blamed some of the bizarre entries on overzealous enumerators who seemed determined to write something or the other in the occupancy column against every individual. Infants, for instance, were listed as ‘sucking’, children as simply ‘playing’, and newcomers to a village as ‘guests’.

Further confusion arose with the term *pesha-i-khud*, loosely translated as self-employed. Its frequent appearance left senior officers scratching their heads, unsure of the specific occupations it indicated. Neill even documented the enumerators’ struggle to differentiate between lunatics and idiots, wryly noting ‘it having been impossible to separate them, as the enumerators did not appreciate the distinction between the two classes’.

(Excerpted with permission from Hachette India from Shantanu Nandan Sharma’s *Rebel Bastar: History, Maoism and the Search for Answers in India’s Heartland*)

THE DAILY QUIZ

A look at Lionel Messi’s international career in the wake of the Argentine football legend’s retirement

V.V. Ramanan

- QUESTION 1**
In which year and where did Lionel Messi win the Olympic Gold and the Under-20 World Cup?
- QUESTION 2**
How many goals and assists did Messi net in his 207-match career for ‘La Albiceleste’?
- QUESTION 3**
Messi had a senior international debut to forget on August 17, 2005, because he was shown a straight red card, less than a minute after coming on in the 63rd minute, for an accidental elbow to an opponent.

- Against which European team did this happen?
- QUESTION 4**
Which final heartbreak prompted Messi’s first international retirement in June 2016?
- QUESTION 5**
Messi holds the record for most major tournament goals in men’s history with how many goals?
- QUESTION 6**
With whom does Messi share the record for FIFA World Cup appearances (six in total)?
- QUESTION 7**
Against which South American country has he netted the most international goals (11)?



Visual question: In this image, Messi is celebrating the triumph in which tournament? REUTERS

- Questions and answers to the previous day’s daily quiz:**
1. This British constitutional initiative provided the framework for the formation of the Interim Government. **Ans: The Cabinet Mission Plan of 1946**
2. The Commander-in-Chief of India while the Interim govt. was in operation. **Ans: General Sir Claude Auchinleck**
3. The Muslim League finally joined the Interim Government on this date. **Ans: October 26, 1946**
4. The members of the Constituent Assembly, from which the Interim Government was formed were chosen through this mechanism. **Ans: They were not elected directly by the public. Members were elected by the provincial legislative assemblies**
5. The Interim Government ceased to exist on this date. Mention the major constitutional event which brought its tenure to an end. **Ans: It ceased to exist on August 15, 1947, when British India was partitioned and power was transferred to the new Dominions of India and Pakistan**
- Visual: Identify these members of the Interim Government. **Ans: (From left) Sarat Chandra Bose, Jagjivan Ram, Rajendra Prasad, Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel, Asaf Ali, Pandit Jawaharlal Nehru and Syed Ali Zaheer**
- Early birds:** Prem Nath Tiwari| Sitaram Saharay| Neil Lall| Anan E A Rahim| Venkat Parthasarathy



FROM THE ARCHIVES

Know your English

S. Upendran

What is the difference between “cousin” and “half brother”? (N. Vardhan, Chennai)
The children of your father’s/ mother’s sister or brother are your “cousins”. In other words, your uncle’s kids or your aunt’s kids are your cousins. For most native speakers of English, cousins are what we in India call “first cousins”. In India, however, we have a tendency to introduce anyone who is distantly related to us as “my cousin”. Native speakers of English do not do this.

A “half brother” is someone who shares the same father or mother as you. In other words, if you have a half brother, it implies that you either have a stepfather or a stepmother.

What is the meaning of “on the qui vive”? (A. Umar, Kadayanallur)
First, let’s deal with the pronunciation. “Qui” is pronounced like the word “key” and “ive” in “vive” sounds like the word “eve”.

When you say that someone is “on the qui vive”, what you are implying is that he/she is alert; he/she is watching very carefully. This is what the expression means in English.

Geetha is always on the qui vive for bargains.

The soldiers were on the qui vive for another assault.

What is the difference between an “escort” and a “convoy”? (P. Parshuram, Secunderabad)
An “escort” is something or someone that is given to an individual as a mark of respect or as a form of protection. For example, Ministers in our country always have bodyguards surrounding them. The bodyguards are their escorts; they go wherever the Minister goes. Similarly, when an actress attends a party, she usually has an escort. When Hema Malini was young, her mother escorted her to most parties.

A “convoy”, on the other hand, refers to the vehicles that accompany someone important. Whenever a Chief Minister goes somewhere, he/she usually has about ten or fifteen cars following him/her. These cars are part of the convoy. Unlike the word “escort”, a convoy is usually used to refer to things (cars, lorries, ships, etc); the word is not used to refer to people.

What is the origin of the term “Molotov cocktail”? (M. R. Hareesh, Taliparamba)
Let me begin by telling you that this “cocktail” is no drink. A “Molotov cocktail” is a homemade firebomb! It usually consists of an inflammable liquid in a bottle to which a wick is attached. The wick is then lit and the bottle is thrown at someone or something. The result? The bottle explodes and the object catches fire. We see a lot of such bombs used by the villains in our regional films.

“Molotov cocktail” is named after V.M. Molotov, the man who was the Foreign Minister of the Soviet Union during World War II. When the Nazis invaded Russia during the Second World War, the Russian civilians used this cocktail quite successfully to destroy the German tanks. *Published in The Hindu on November 11, 2001*

Word of the day

Excoriate:
express strong disapproval of

Synonyms: condemn, reprobate, decry

Usage: *The activists excoriated the violence against minority communities.*

Pronunciation: newsth.live/excoriate

International Phonetic Alphabet: /ɪkˈskoʊ.i.ɛt/

For feedback and suggestions for Text & Context, please write to **letters@thehindu.co.in** with the subject ‘Text & Context’

CBI should probe ‘cash for transfer scam’ in Punjab: BJP

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) on Wednesday demanded the resignation of Punjab Chief Minister Bhagwant Mann and a Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI) probe into the “cash for transfer” charges in the State.

There were serious allegations of institutional corruption in Punjab, BJP spokesperson Gaurav Bhatia said. Citing the purported findings of a probe by the Enforcement Directorate (ED), he alleged that money was being taken for the transfers and postings of senior bureaucrats and police officers.

Confidential government documents had reached middlemen, but despite seven letters from the ED, no FIR had been registered, the BJP leader said. He demanded the immediate resignation of Mr. Mann and a fair investigation by the CBI.

Claiming that Aam Aadmi Party chief Arvind Kejriwal and Mr. Mann “have today become symbols of corruption”, Mr. Bhatia alleged that senior Punjab officials were involved in the “scam”. “Their transfers



Gaurav Bhatia

and postings are carried out according to a rate card... This rate card fixes the price for who will get which charge and in which department they will be posted,” he said.

The facts presented by the ED before the Punjab and Haryana High Court in its affidavit revealed that confidential documents, draft lists of postings and transfers, and draft lists of government policies to be implemented in the future were found on WhatsApp on the mobile phones of alleged middlemen and touts, Mr. Bhatia said.

“The concerning aspect is that... the ED told the Punjab Police that this was a cognisable offence and that an FIR should be registered. However, despite seven letters being written to the Punjab Police, no FIR was registered,” he said.

Air Force veteran appointed first Ram Temple Trust CEO

Air Vice-Marshal Jitendra Mishra (ret'd) served in IAF for 31 years; Mahesh Bhagchandka, Madan Mohan Pandey, Nirmala Yadav named trustees; move comes amid allegation of donation theft

Ishita Mishra
NEW DELHI

The Shri Ram Janmabhoomi Teerth Kshetra Trust on Wednesday appointed Air Vice-Marshal Jitendra Mishra (ret'd) as its first chief executive officer.

The appointment came at a time when the Trust is strengthening its administrative structure amid allegations of theft of donations at the Ram Temple in Ayodhya.

The appointment was announced after a meeting of the Trust at the Maniram Das Chawani in Ayodhya, where the trustees also filled three vacant positions on the Board.

The vacancies arose following the resignations of senior Vishwa Hindu Parishad (VHP) leader and general secretary Champat Rai, and trustee Anil Mishra. They quit in July after the embezzlement allegations surfaced.

The third vacancy arose after the death of trustee Vimlendra Pratap Mishra, a member of Ayodhya's erstwhile royal family.

According to a commu-



Air Vice-Marshal Jitendra Mishra (ret'd) was awarded the Sarvottam Yudh Seva Medal and was also a part of Operation Sindoor. PTI

nique issued by the Trust, Air Vice-Marshal Mishra was appointed following the recommendations of a committee constituted to select the CEO.

The process involved scrutinising about 5,585 applications, and interviewing hundreds of candidates over a period of nearly two months.

Air Vice-Marshal Mishra served in the Indian Air Force for 31 years, holding positions across different departments and gaining extensive leadership experience, the Trust said.

It added that the new CEO was also awarded the Sarvottam Yudh Seva Me-

dal, one of the highest military decorations for distinguished service in wartime. He was also part of Operation Sindoor.

‘Unaware of selection’

He had not been aware of his selection prior to the announcement made to the media on Wednesday, Air Vice-Marshal Mishra told *The Hindu*.

“I also got to know about my selection through television. I am elated,” he said.

The trustees also appointed three new members – Mahesh Bhagchandka, Madan Mohan Pandey, and Nirmala Yadav – to fill

the vacant positions. Mr. Bhagchandka is associated with Ashok Singhla Foundation, while Mr. Pandey is an advocate.

Ms. Yadav will be the first woman to hold a trusteeship in the Trust.

Swami Govind Dev Giri will continue as the Trust's general secretary, while Mr. Bhagchandka will take charge as treasurer. The Trust's annual accounts for 2025-26 have also been approved.

Financial details

The Trust recorded a total income of about ₹237 crore, and expenditure of about ₹99 crore during the financial year. It also incurred about ₹425 crore in capital expenditure on construction and related works. As of March 31, the Trust had total funds of about ₹1,882 crore.

The VHP hailed the appointment of the CEO. VHP president Alok Kumar described Air Vice-Marshal Mishra as a senior and respected personality, adding that his extensive experience would help the Trust function more effectively and transparently.

Provide security to rural communities before a crisis strikes, says Cong. chief

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge on Wednesday said rural communities should not be remembered only during droughts, floods, crop failures or elections, and called for a development model that provides them security before a crisis strikes.

He was speaking at an event organised by the Dr. Y.S. Rajasekhara Reddy Foundation and the Dr. KVP Foundation, where the M.S. Swaminathan Research Foundation (MSSRF) was conferred the Dr. Y.S. Rajasekhara Reddy Award, 2026.

Mr. Kharge said governments must ensure that farmers have fair markets, rural families have decent livelihoods, and women have economic indepen-



Big honour: Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge with Telangana Chief Minister Revanth Reddy in New Delhi on Wednesday. PTI

dence, while tribal communities and villages need access to technology, opportunities and basic infrastructure. “The government has an important role in creating this security, so that the communities become partners in India's development,” he said.

The Congress president also took a swipe at the

Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh. Without naming anyone, he said he had heard an RSS leader claim that India had witnessed many reforms. Mr. Kharge said it was the Congress that had carried out the reforms being referred to.

Linking the award to the legacies of Rajasekhara Reddy and agricultural

scientist M.S. Swaminathan, Mr. Kharge said both believed that development must ultimately serve the dignity of ordinary people.

Rajasekhara Reddy, he said, had worked for the poor and marginalised, while Swaminathan had sought to combine scientific advancement with social equity and environmental sustainability.

Paying tribute to Swaminathan, Mr. Kharge recalled his contribution to the Green Revolution and recalled how the late scientists had described Indira Gandhi as the “most successful warrior against hunger”.

In a video message, Soumya Swaminathan, chair of the MSSRF and daughter of M.S. Swaminathan thanked the organisers for conferring the award on the foundation.

Kapil Sibal seeks SC intervention over ‘bulk SIR deletions’

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Rajya Sabha member Kapil Sibal on Wednesday urged the Supreme Court to stop the “bulk deletions” taking place under the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls.

Mr. Sibal alleged that the ongoing SIR was aimed at helping the BJP win elections. In a post on X, he termed it “politics of exclusion”, and alleged that “BJP agents” were looking to “target Muslims, seek bulk deletions”. He added, “Supreme Court needs to stop this!”

Addressing a press conference here, Mr. Sibal cited a report from Jharkhand, alleging that the form to request the deletion of names from the voters' list was being filed in bulk by BJP workers.

“You can file bulk forms – you can take 45 of them,

or 100 of them, or even 400 of them. You can file the forms, and you can say that this name should be deleted. You don't have to give any reason for it, and if it is found to be false, it doesn't matter,” he said.

Earlier, *The Hindu* had reported that cases of Form 7 being submitted in bulk had surfaced in States like Rajasthan, Gujarat and Assam.

‘Serious issue’

Mr. Sibal alleged that many people whose names were sought to be deleted were Muslims and had been living in their area for years.

“Therefore, this is a very serious issue, and if courts don't take care of this issue, if courts just believe that the SIR exercise is by a neutral EC, then I think we are in deep trouble; this democracy will be in deep trouble,” the Rajya Sabha member said.

Former AIMIM leader joins Congress ahead of 2027 U.P. election

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Syed Asim Waqar, former spokesperson of the All India Majlis-e-Ittehadul Muslimeen (AIMIM), joined the Congress on Wednesday, alleging that the Asaduddin Owaisi-led party paid lip service to the objective of defeating the Bharatiya Janata Party while fighting the Opposition parties on the ground.

Mr. Waqar joined the Congress at the party headquarters here in the presence of All India Congress Committee (AICC) in-charge for Uttar Pradesh Rajendra Pal Gautam, State Congress president Ajay Rai and AICC Minority Department chairman Imran Pratapgarhi.

Explaining his decision, Mr. Waqar said his years in the AIMIM had convinced him that a party seeking to remove the BJP from pow-



Syed Asim Waqar

er could not simultaneously weaken those fighting the ruling party. “If we keep fighting the Opposition and do not allow it to grow, then we are helping the BJP,” Mr. Waqar said.

Mr. Rai said Mr. Waqar's induction would strengthen the party in Uttar Pradesh ahead of the 2027 Assembly election. A key AIMIM voice in Uttar Pradesh and considered close to Mr. Owaisi, Mr. Waqar's exit comes as the AIMIM seeks to expand its political footprint in the State.

Rahul takes stock of Maharashtra issues

Vinaya Deshpande Pandit
MUMBAI

Congress leader Rahul Gandhi on Wednesday sought a detailed assessment of key political issues in Maharashtra, including the deletion of names from the electoral rolls, Maratha and OBC reservation issues and tribal protests.

He is in Nashik for the

party's *Sanghatan Srujan Abhiyan*.

Later, Mr. Gandhi interacted with the families of the district Congress committee presidents before addressing the concluding session of the training camp. He urged the district presidents to expand the organisation and take the Congress's ideology to people across the State.

**MAHATRANSKO**
Maharashtra State Electricity Transmission Co. Ltd.

**INVITATION FOR BID (IFB)
(LOCAL COMPETITIVE BIDDING)**

SRM e-Tender No. T-2662/MSETCL/CO/Projects/Pre-Tender (RFx No. 6000001567) (2nd Call)
MSETCL invites offers by SRM e-tendering in TWO bid system (Techno-Commercial Bid and Price Bid) from the eligible registered bidders for the following work as detailed below.
“Establishment of 220/33kV Murmi (Dahegaon Bangla) S/S along with construction of LILo on existing 220kV Waluj Chitegaon SC line (RL-12.99km) at 220kV Murmi Substation, Tal. Gangapur, Dist. Ch. Sambhajinagar under Ch. Sambhajinagar Zone, MSETCL, Maharashtra.”
Interested bidders may obtain further information available on the website. <https://srmetender.mahatransco.in>
The date of downloading of Bid documents available on the website is from **31.08.2026**.
**Sd/-
Chief Engineer (Projects), MSETCL**

**BENGALURU CENTRAL CITY CORPORATION**
Office of the Executive Engineer, Shivaji Nagar Division, Thimmaiah Road, Queens Road, Bangalore

Tender NO. EE/SJN/E-PROC/27/2026-27
Date: 02.09.2026

**INVITATION FOR SHORT TERM TENDER
(TWO COVER SYSTEM)**
(Through GOK KPP Portal <https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in> only)
The Executive Engineer (Shivaji Nagar Division), BCCC, Bangalore invites tenders from eligible Contractors registered in CPWD / KPWD / Railways /MES/ National Highway or any State Government Organizations for the construction of work detailed in the table below.
Standard Tender Document KW4.

Sl. No.	Name of the Work
1.	Heritage restoration, Reconstruction & development of Russel Market in Shivajinagara in Bengaluru City Amount Put to Tender : Rs.7,000.00 Lakhs. EMD : Rs.70,00,000.00.

Calendar of Events : (1) Tenders must be submitted online through e-procurement portal on or before **16.00 hours on 03.10.2026** and the opening of tenders will be as per the e-procurement portal guidelines. (2) Pre bid meeting will be held on **24.09.2026 at 15.00** in the office of the Chief Engineer Zone-2, Bengaluru City Central Palike, Annexure-3, 4th Floor, GBA office compound, N R Square, Bengaluru (3) Last Date for uploading the Filled Tender Document is **03.10.2026 upto 16.00pm**. (4) Date of Technical bid opening of Tenders is on **05.10.2026 by 11.00 am** (5) Date of Financial bid Opening of Tenders is on after Technical bid approved.
Sd/- Executive Engineer, Shivaji Nagar Division, BCCC

Cong. cites Garg's analysis to question GDP growth figures

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI



These claims cannot simply be dismissed. They come from someone who served as Finance and Economic Affairs Secretary of the Government under Modi between 2017 and 2019

PAWAN KHERA
Congress leader

The Congress on Wednesday stepped up its attack on the Union government over the latest GDP figures, citing reported remarks by former Finance Secretary Subhash Chandra Garg to argue that the Centre was using statistical revisions to present an inflated picture of economic growth.

Congress general secretary (communications) Jairam Ramesh shared a video clip of Mr. Garg, who said that revisions to the previous year's GDP had affected comparisons with the current year's figures.

According to Mr. Garg, without the revision, growth at current prices in the April-June quarter would have been around 2.6%, instead of the higher figure being projected.

Mr. Ramesh said the government's claims of robust economic growth, amplified through what he described as statistical “jugglery”, were at odds with conditions on the ground.

‘Burst the bubble’

“Former Finance Secretary Subhash Garg has now burst the bubble on this claim. His assessment is that the real GDP growth is around 2.6%, not 7.8%,” Mr. Ramesh said in a post on social media platform X. “The Modi government must understand: PR can polish the picture of GDP, but not the economy itself,” he said.

The Congress leader said the government needed to acknowledge the actual state of the economy and undertake reforms to

generate employment, strengthen MSMEs and private investment, raise demand and incomes, reduce inequality and ensure fair competition instead of promoting “crony capitalists”.

Mr. Ramesh said it was significant that questions were being raised over the GDP figures by a former Finance Secretary who had served in the Modi government.

Congress media and publicity department chairman Pawan Khera said Mr. Garg's assessment appeared closer to the “lived reality” of ordinary Indians, marked by rising prices, weakening purchasing power, shrinking disposable incomes and savings, stagnant employment opportunities and increasing household debt.

Seeks explanation

“These claims cannot simply be dismissed. They come from someone who served as Finance and Economic Affairs Secretary of the Government of India under Modi between 2017 and 2019,” Mr. Khera said, demanding an explanation for the revision of the previous year's GDP figures.

**Maharashtra State Agricultural Marketing Board,Pune (MSAMB)**

E-Tender Notice

MSAMB invites e-Tender for Construction of a Modern Primary Processing Center for Orange at Agricultural Produce Market Committee, Katol (Sub Market Khangoan), Taluka - Katol, Dist.Nagpur. Estimated cost of said work is Rs.625.23 Lakhs (GST extra). For details, please visit www.msamb.com and <https://mahatenders.gov.in>.
Managing Director

**MAHATRANSKO**
Maharashtra State Electricity Transmission Co. Ltd.

**INVITATION FOR BID (IFB)
(LOCAL COMPETITIVE BIDDING)**

SRM e-Tender No. T-2671/MSETCL/CO/Projects/Pre-Tender (RFx No. 6000001585) (2nd Call)
MSETCL invites offers by SRM e-tendering in TWO bid system (Techno-Commercial Bid and Price Bid) from the eligible registered bidders for the following work as detailed below.
“Establishment of 110/22kV Gaikwadpada GIS substation, Dist. Thane with associated lines using 220kV equipments and UG cable on turnkey basis under Vashi Zone, MSETCL, Maharashtra.”
Interested bidders may obtain further information available on the website. <https://srmetender.mahatransco.in>
The date of downloading of Bid documents available on the website is from **27.08.2026**.
**Sd/-
Chief Engineer (Projects), MSETCL**

**MAHATRANSKO**
Maharashtra State Electricity Transmission Co. Ltd.

**INVITATION FOR BID (IFB)
(LOCAL COMPETITIVE BIDDING)**

SRM e-Tender No. T-2681/MSETCL/CO/Projects/Pre-Tender (RFx No. 6000001579) (2nd Call)
MSETCL invites offers by SRM e-tendering in TWO bid system (Techno-Commercial Bid and Price Bid) from the eligible registered bidders for the following work as detailed below.
“Work of (A) Establishment of 400/220kV Kalwa GIS Substation along with reorientation of 400kV and 220kV lines & (B) Establishment of 400/220kV Padghe Split GIS Substation along with reorientation of 400kV and 220kV lines under Vashi Zone, MSETCL, Maharashtra.”
Interested bidders may obtain further information available on the website. <https://srmetender.mahatransco.in>
The date of downloading of Bid documents available on the website is from **27.08.2026**.
**Sd/-
Chief Engineer (Projects), MSETCL**

कार्यालय अधिशाषी अभियन्ता सा.नि.वि. खण्ड घाटोल
जिला बांसवाड़ा (राज.)
क्रमांक :- 515
दिनांक :- 18/08/2026

निविदा संशोधन
निविदा सूचना संख्या 07/2026-27
NIB CODE:- PWD262742362

इस खण्ड कार्यालय के पत्रांक 499 दिनांक 14.08.2026 द्वारा आमंत्रित निविदा सूचना संख्या 07/2026-27 में दलित कार्य संख्या 1 एवं 4 में विधिल कार्य हेतु अनुमानित लागत राशि एवं बरोहर राशि में विनानुसार संशोधन किया जाता है :-

कार्य क्रम संख्या	पूर्व निर्धारित अनुमानित लागत (लाखों में)	पूर्व निर्धारित बरोहर राशि (लाखों में)	संशोधित अनुमानित लागत (लाखों में)	संशोधित बरोहर राशि (लाखों में)
1	42.50	8500	21250	42.52
2	32.66	65320	16330	38.54
				77080

नोट- निविदा की शेष राशि मूल निविदा सूचना अनुसार रहेगी।
(सोपान विवरण)
अधिशाषी अभियन्ता सा.नि.वि. खंड घाटोल
DIPRC/15544/2026

**MAHATRANSKO**
Maharashtra State Electricity Transmission Co. Ltd.

**INVITATION FOR BID (IFB)
(LOCAL COMPETITIVE BIDDING)**

SRM e-Tender No. T-2681/MSETCL/CO/Projects/Pre-Tender (RFx No. 6000001579) (2nd Call)
MSETCL invites offers by SRM e-tendering in TWO bid system (Techno-Commercial Bid and Price Bid) from the eligible registered bidders for the following work as detailed below.
“Work of (A) Establishment of 400/220kV Kalwa GIS Substation along with reorientation of 400kV and 220kV lines & (B) Establishment of 400/220kV Padghe Split GIS Substation along with reorientation of 400kV and 220kV lines under Vashi Zone, MSETCL, Maharashtra.”
Interested bidders may obtain further information available on the website. <https://srmetender.mahatransco.in>
The date of downloading of Bid documents available on the website is from **27.08.2026**.
**Sd/-
Chief Engineer (Projects), MSETCL**

Following a drop in his blood sugar level, Jalna Collector Ashima Mittal appealed to Maratha quota activist Manoj Jarange-Patil to end his indefinite hunger strike, which entered the fifth day on Wednesday. Meanwhile, activists from the Maratha community started *rasta roko* (road blockade) protests in Dharashiv, Beed, Jalna, and Solapur districts of Maharashtra, demanding a resolution to their demands in the quota issue. The two-hour protest disrupted traffic in many areas. Mr. Jarange-Patil refused to withdraw the his protest, and asserted that the demands raised by the protesters involved State government-level decisions.

The Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI) has organised a two-day case coordination meeting between India and Thailand on 'Live Animal Trafficking' which commenced on Wednesday. The CBI is co-hosting the meeting in coordination with the Interpol Environmental Security Sub-Directorate (ENS). "The smuggling of exotic live animals and birds for pet trade is a growing trend in Asia. Mainly using air routes, live animals are being trafficked from Thailand, Malaysia, and Indonesia to South Asian countries, including India; Singapore is used as a transit point," said the agency.

CM
Y
K



Bengaluru-based EV manufacturer Simple Energy on Wednesday unveiled Simple Wave, a new range of electric scooters aimed at family buyers. The range comprises three variants and is available in six colours – Pearl White, Coral Red, Twilight Black, Polar Blue, Dolphin Grey and Forest Green. The company claims the scooters offer an IDC range of up to 243 km and storage capacity of up to 70 litres. Prices start at ₹1,09,999 (ex-showroom).

Danish biosolutions company Novonesis has announced an investment of ₹6,660 crore (€600 million) to expand its facility at Patalganga in Maharashtra and establish an advanced enzyme production facility. The expansion is aimed at increasing the company's production capacity to meet growing global demand for biosolutions. The new facility, which is expected to be fully operational by 2030, will manufacture enzymes for a range of industries, including biofuels.

Essel Group Chairman Subhash Chandra on Wednesday opposed the formation of a five-member bench by the NCLT to decide his personal insolvency case, contending that the tribunal does not have the power to constitute such a bench. Appearing for Mr. Chandra before the appellate tribunal NCLAT, Senior Advocate Sasmit Patra termed the NCLT order “faulty and wrong” and said, “they are not empowered” to form a five-member bench. PTI

M. Soundariya Preetha
COIMBATORE

Textile mills are witnessing a revival in cotton-yarn demand with capacity utilisation crossing 90% but a sharp rise in cotton prices is raising concerns over operational sustainability.

“Cotton yarn demand started reviving almost five months ago and now, mills are not holding much yarn stocks,” said Durai Palanisamy, chairman, Southern India Mills Association.

Cotton prices had risen sharply since mid-March, with local prices moving in line with ICE Futures, he said, adding mills had relatively low inventories with most maintaining less than two months stock.

Cotton prices which ranged between ₹51,700-₹57,000 a candy between October last and end March 2026 surged to ₹70,000/candy on September 2 on an ex-gin basis.

“Factors such as higher demand from China and likely lower output from the U.S. and China are pushing up prices,” said Nishant Asher, secretary, Indian Cotton Federation.

"Our cotton yarn cannot be used fully by local apparel sector. Textile mills need global opportunities for viable operations. Yarn prices adjust to cotton prices. Globally, too, yarn availability is under pressure, boosting prices," said Ravi Sam, vice-chairman, Cotton Textile Export Promotion Council.

Sources said Indian cotton prices were lower than global prices. The Cotton Corporation of India, which procured huge quantities of cotton at minimum support price, must stabilise prices.

Saptaparno Ghosh
NEW DELHI

Consultations are on for introducing a new tender for wind offshore technology in Tamil Nadu, Rajesh Kulkarni, Joint Secretary, Union Renewable Ministry told reporters here.

Mr. Kulhari said feasibility studies conducted in the State had yielded positive results.

"All [feasibility] studies have been completed in Tamil Nadu. The good news is capacity utilisation factor is more than 50%," he stated, adding, "collection of required data for offshore wind off the coast of Tamil Nadu, that is, wind velocity, geo-technical and geo-physical – have been completed by the National Institute of Wind Energy (NIWE)."

Sanjana B
BENGALURU

Almost a quarter of PayPal's about 6,700 India staff have either been laid off or are in the process of being laid off, sources said.

A PayPal spokesperson said, "The recent staffing changes are part of previously announced multi-year transformation to simplify global operations, strengthen execution and position the firm for long-term growth. We are committed to supporting staff through this transition."

In May, media reports

According to RBI data, this includes \$1,27,226 mn via FCNR(B) deposits, \$5,260 mn through OFCBS and \$3,891 mn via ECBs; central bank may prioritise closing its short forward dollar positions with the FCNR(B) deposits received, say insiders

Lalatendu Mishra
Ashokamithran
MUMBAI

Foreign exchange inflows via foreign currency non-resident (Bank) FCNR(B) deposits, overseas foreign currency borrowings (OFCBs) and external commercial borrowings (ECBs) under the Reserve Bank of India's (RBI) swap facility have crossed \$136 billion, surpassing all projections.

A total of \$1,36,377 million has been mobilised, as per data released by the RBI. This includes \$1,27,226 million through FCNR (B) deposits, \$5,260 million through OFCBS and \$3,891 million through ECB.



Cushioning impact: The RBI has already begun absorbing rupee liquidity to ensure call rates did not fall below policy rate. REUTERS

The RBI had introduced a special USD-INR forex swap facility covering these instruments on June 8 this year to deal with forex outflows due to high oil prices and flight of capital owing to exit of Foreign

Portfolio Investors (FOIs)
from the stock market.

The central bank may prioritise closing its \$137 billion short forward dollar positions with the FCNR (B) deposits received, according to experts and in-

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Japan Credit Rating Agency (JCR) has upgraded India's credit rating by one notch from BBB+ to 'A-', it announced on Wednesday, on the back of India's relatively high growth, the government's growth-oriented policies, and the improved strength of the financial system.

saying that this comes against the backdrop of a challenging global environment.

A higher rating means that India can borrow at lower costs in the future, leading to a lower interest burden on the exchequer.

“The Indian economy has maintained a high

growth rate of around 7%, supported by robust private consumption and public investment,” JCR said in its rationale for the ratings upgrade. “The government of India has steadily implemented policies conducive to productivity growth and economic development, including the development of digital public infrastructure and the implementation of the goods and services tax (GST), strengthening the country’s economic foundations as compared to the past.” it added.

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Quebec-based La Caisse pension fund announced on Wednesday that it was acquiring a 24% stake in Altius Telecom Infrastructure Trust, India's largest trust through which tower and other telecom infrastructure spending is directed. The acquisition entails a CA\$1.76 billion investment, or ₹12,100 crore.

Canadian investment management MNC Brookfield remains the SEBI-registered Infrastructure Investment Trust (InvIT)'s largest shareholder.

‘Reflective of demand’

In a statement alongside Brookfield, La Caisse said that its acquisition “reflects growing demand for mobile connectivity and 5G infrastructure in India”.

The pension fund added, “India is the world’s second-largest telecommunications market, and continued growth in mobile data use and 5G is increasing the need for digital infrastructure.”

While two of the three private telecom operators have spread their 5G networks throughout every district in India in record time, infrastructure spending is expected to grow as many sites are not directly connected through fiber optic cables, and more sites need to be added to expand coverage in semi-urban and rural areas to meet growing traffic demand by users.






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Hong Kong activist Joshua Wong pleads guilty to 'foreign collusion'



'Mechanism needed for Black Sea safety before grain crisis escalates'



11 injured in Kyiv as Russian attacks continue for seventh straight day



Congo's Ebola outbreak shows no signs of slowing; deaths top 3,000



Iran fires on its Gulf neighbours in retaliation for renewed U.S. strikes

Hopes of finding survivors dim week after Nepal flood

U.S.-Sri Lanka operation busts drug network

Taliban defend ban on protests, saying it 'does not exist in Islamic law system'



Uttarakhand Tourism Development Board (UTDB)
 Pandit Deendayal Upadhyay Paryatan Bhawan, Near O.N.G.C. Halipad,
 Nimbubwala, Garhi Cantt, Dehradun - 248003 (UK)
 Ph. 0135-2559898, Fax 135-2559988

Ref. No. 3230/2-7-1020/2026-27 Dated: 02 September, 2026

UTDB invites tender for Supply of Ski Equipment to the Uttarakhand Tourism Development Board (UTDB), Dehradun, Uttarakhand

Details may be obtained on website: uktenders.gov.in and uttarakhandtourism.gov.in from 3:00 PM on 03.09.2026. Prospective Bidders may seek clarification till 03:00 PM on 08.09.2026 through E-mail: adventurewingutdb@gmail.com with CC to procurement.utdb@gmail.com. Any Addendum/Corrigendum including date extension will be uploaded only on uktenders.gov.in. Bids must be submitted online through uktenders.gov.in only. The last date for submission of bids is 26.09.2026 till 15:00 PM.

Chief Executive Officer

EALA MANIA

‘We’re very loud when it comes to supporting our people’



AP Alex Eala's fans arrived in huge numbers when she trained and then played in her first round US Open match. One of them was Andrea Belen, who FaceTimed with her father during the session so he could see Eala. “Everyone went crazy. We’re very loud when it comes to supporting our people,” said Belen.

DOUBLY SWEET

To play on the day of my 40th birthday was special: Monfils



AFF Gael Monfils stood in the middle of the court and bowed to the crowd that treated the Frenchman to a roaring ovation on his 40th birthday. “To play on the day of my 40th birthday was special. You guys made it incredible,” said Monfils to the fans at the Louis Armstrong Stadium, who sang happy birthday to him.

SHOWTIME

Frodin, Serena’s body double in King Richard, hogs the limelight



AP Thea Frodin once had to hit like Serena Williams in the King Richard movie in 2021. On Tuesday at the US Open, the 17-year-old showed some pretty good power of her own in real life. “Being aggressive has always been my game. Hopefully, the next time I meet her [Rybakina], I will see what I can do,” said Frodin.

IN THE HOTSEAT

Red Bull’s Lawson to race in Italian GP as injury keeps Hadjar out



REUTERS Liam Lawson will remain Max Verstappen’s teammate at Red Bull for the Italian GP after Isack Hadjar failed to recover in time from his wrist injury, the team confirmed. Hadjar had said he was hopeful of returning for Sunday’s race but will now miss a second event. Yuki Tsunoda gets a second race with Racing Bulls in Lawson’s seat.

Zverev battles back from the brink to subdue Sonogo

The top-seeded German was two points from defeat in the fourth set; French Open runner-up Cobolli also wins five-set marathon; Rybakina and Gauff move up with ease on rain-affected day

US OPEN

Agence France-Presse
NEW YORK

Top-seeded Alexander Zverev survived a scare, overcoming Lorenzo Sonogo in a wild-five setter at the US Open on Tuesday as Elena Rybakina and Coco Gauff advanced with ease.

Zverev fought off a determined challenge from Italy’s lowly ranked Sonogo, winning 6-4, 3-6, 6-7(7), 7-5, 6-4 in a tense all-court battle spiced by unlikely retrievals, impossibly angled winners and some inexplicable errors, which wrapped up on Arthur Ashe Stadium after four hours and 53 minutes at 1:55 in the morning.

“I’m just happy I won, that’s it. Incredible battle,” said Zverev, who was two points from defeat trailing 5-4 in the fourth set.

The German held serve and broke Sonogo in the next game, then earned the lone break of the fifth set to complete the win.

Fifth-seeded Flavio Cobolli, runner-up to Zverev at Roland Garros, rallied from two sets down for the first time in his career to beat Argentina’s Francisco Comesana 3-6, 2-6, 6-3, 6-4, 6-4.

Nerves didn’t seem to be a problem for ninth-seeded Taylor Fritz as he sailed past fellow American Darwin Blanch 6-3, 6-2, 6-4.

There was no such drama for women’s World No. 2 Rybakina and former champion Gauff. Rybakina, eyeing a third Grand Slam title and the top ranking, beat US teen Thea Frodin



REUTERS Finding his range: Zverev conjured up unlikely retrievals and hit impossibly angled winners.

IMPORTANT RESULTS

Men: Second round: 7-Medvedev bt Gorznyi (USA) 6-1, 6-3, 7-5; Michelsen (USA) bt 16-Nakashima (USA) 6-3, 6-4, 6-4. First round: 1-Zverev (Ger) bt Sonogo (Ita) 6-4, 3-6, 6-7(7), 7-5, 6-4; 13-Musetti (Ita) bt Fery (GBR) 6-3, 6-3, 7-5; 9-Fritz (USA) bt Blanch (USA) 6-3, 6-2, 6-4; 24-Cerundolo (Arg) bt Misolic (Aut) 6-4, 6-3, 7-5; 5-Cobolli (Ita) bt Comesana (Arg) 3-6, 2-6, 6-3, 6-4, 6-4. Women: Second round: 19-Paolini (Ita) bt Stefanini (Ita) 6-4, 6-1; 31-Fernandez (Can) bt Sawangkaew (Tha) 6-4, 6-1; 15-Shnaider bt Pliskova (Cze) 6-1, 6-3, 6-2.

Gauff showed off her immensely improved serve in a confident 6-3, 6-4 victory over 53rd-ranked Zeynep Sonmez of Turkey. Gauff blazed through the opening set before Sonmez upped her game, recovering an early break in the second and briefly tak-

ing the lead before Gauff regrouped. Kazakhstan’s Rybakina showed little sign of the left heel injury that forced her out of her quarterfinal in Cincinnati this month. She saved both break points she faced in a polished performance against the big-hitting if erratic American, who was playing her first Grand Slam main draw match on a wild card.

Women’s French Open champion Mirra Andreeva also advanced easily, cruising past Indonesia’s 36th-ranked Janice Tjen 6-2, 6-2. Keys, a former Australian Open winner who lost in the first round at Flushing Meadows last year, conquered first-match jitters to beat 19-year-old Russian Alina Korneeva 7-5, 6-4. While play went as scheduled on the covered Ashe and Armstrong stadiums, those on outside courts – including Rybakina – had to wait out some lengthy rain delays. That included a near four-hour delay to the start of play and more delays in the evening. Five late matches were postponed altogether and a handful of others suspended.

2-6(4); 3-Pegula (USA) bt Kenin (USA) 6-3, 6-1. First round: 5-Andreeva bt Tjen (Ina) 6-2, 6-2; 24-Potapova (Aut) bt Semenistaja (Lat) 6-2, 6-2; 4-Gauff (USA) bt Sonmez (Tur) 6-3, 6-4; 22-Keys (USA) bt Korneeva 7-5, 6-4; 17-Eala (Phi) bt Stoiana (USA) 6-1, 6-2; Putintseva (Kaz) bt 12-Bencic (Sui) 4-6, 7-5, 6-3; 23-Mertens (Bel) bt Quevedo (Esp) 6-4, 6-4; 32-Sakkari (Gre) bt Montgomery (USA) 2-6, 7-5, 6-2; 2-Rybakina (Kaz) bt Frodin (USA) 6-3, 6-2. Fallen seeds: Men: 16-Nakashima; Women: 12-Bencic.

Stakeholders to meet today to chart India’s roadmap till ODI World Cup

Amol Karhadkar
MUMBAI

The Board of Control for Cricket in India (BCCI) will convene a critical stock-taking meeting of key stakeholders of India’s men’s cricket teams at its headquarters here on Thursday.

It is understood that the meeting will seek to take a deep dive into the issues that have affected India’s performances of late and chart a roadmap through to next year’s ODI World Cup, including a possible extension of chief selector Ajit Agarkar’s tenure.

Multiple sources in the BCCI have confirmed that head coach Gautam Gambhir, Agarkar, Centre of Excellence head of cricket V.V.S. Laxman, captains Shubman Gill and Shreyas



Agarkar’s extension as chief selector will be discussed. FILE PHOTO: EMMANUEL YOGINI

Iyer, and BCCI secretary Devajit Saikia will attend the meeting in person. Two key BCCI executives are also expected to be present, while some other office-bearers may join via videoconference.

Having taken charge in July 2023, Agarkar’s current contract expires at the

end of this month. With BCCI regulations capping a selector’s tenure at four years, he is eligible to continue until next September.

That would ensure continuity through the ODI World Cup, scheduled to begin in October 2027. However, India’s poor returns in ODIs and the cold war between Agarkar and the BCCI hierarchy over Rohit Sharma’s future in international cricket are likely to feature in the deliberations.

The injury-management mechanism at the CoE is another area that has come under criticism from the selection committee and team management. As a result, despite the recent PR overdrive around the CoE, BCCI office-bearers are keen to proactively come

up with a plan for a more effective injury-management system.

Scheduling overlaps between key India-A and international assignments and major domestic fixtures are also expected to be discussed. India-A’s shadow tour of New Zealand coinciding with the ODI series against the Kiwis has left little room for adequate Test preparation ahead of the crucial series in November.

The poor run of the limited-overs teams in Ireland and England will also come under detailed scrutiny. Saikia had announced a review meeting immediately after the England tour concluded in mid-July, but it could not be convened because of the unavailability of key personnel.



K. MURALI KUMAR Leading from the front: Tilak guided South’s chase with a breezy half-century.

I have always loved red-ball cricket: Tilak

N. Sudarshan
BENGALURU

For the current generation of cricket fans, Tilak Varma’s image is that of a dashing, short-format batter for India and Mumbai Indians. But over the last four days in the Duleep Trophy, the 23-year-old revealed another face – that of a steely red-ball player.

Captaining South Zone in the semifinal versus North, he made an unbeaten 116 from 250 balls to rescue his side from a precarious 80 for five. In the second essay, he was unconquered on 51 (79b) as South chased 181 with ease.

“I have always loved red-ball cricket,” Tilak said after his match-winning performance.

“I had never dreamt of playing white-ball [cricket] for India, but it’s God’s plan that I have played T20 and One-day for India. But my strength is the red-ball game.”

Numbers back this assertion. Though he has featured in just two First Class matches in the last 11 months, the Hyderabad southpaw has scored 1,729

runs at an average of 55.77 and a strike-rate of 52.45 from 24 long-format outings. He also has eight centuries and six half-centuries to his name.

“From 2022, I have played a lot of white ball due to IPL and other things, but before that, I have gone through the grind in red ball,” Tilak explained. “No one has seen me since I was 10. It’s always been my strength and it’s there in my blood.”

“In the last three-four years, I am not getting enough time because of the international schedule. But whenever I have had a week, or a break, I have played county and domestic cricket.”

Tilak is the vice-captain of the Indian T20I team, and leadership spurs him on, he stated. “It gives you more responsibility. Since childhood, I have been captaining Hyderabad, across age categories and Ranji Trophy.

“I’ll be thinking, ‘if I am not performing, how will others?’ That extra pressure... I love that. It reflects in my batting too, when the team is under pressure.”

Tilak says he wants to play in the final

N. Sudarshan
BENGALURU

South Zone skipper Tilak Varma expressed hope that he would be able to play the Duleep Trophy final against East Zone in Chennai starting this Sunday despite the short turnaround time between the marquee contest and the first T20I versus Afghanistan.

Tilak, who is India’s T20 vice-captain, will have to finish the final on September 10 and travel to Delhi for the international game scheduled for the 13th. East skipper Ishan Kishan and his deputy Vaibhav Sooryavanshi are also in the same boat.

“I want to play in the final,” Tilak told reporters on Wednesday after the triumph over North Zone. “We have two days break in between. But it depends

on the selectors and the management.”

Tilak hoped that speedster Vidwath Kaverappa, who didn’t take the field starting from the post-tea session on day three (Tuesday), will be available.

“His [left] ankle is slightly swollen, but he can walk and he is also running with a tape. I feel he will be there in the final. But let’s see.”

Karnataka stalwart Karun Nair, who scored 699 runs in the 2025-26 Ranji Trophy, was benched for the semifinal to accommodate Hyderabad’s K. Himateja. Tilak said it was purely because of team combination.

“North had two left-arm spinners, and we wanted a lefty in the middle-order. Himateja is a youngster (24) and has scored decent runs (485). It was very unfortunate for Karun.”

Mumbai, Vadodara to host first women’s CT

Agencies
DUBAI

The International Cricket Council (ICC) announced on Wednesday that the inaugural women’s Champions Trophy 2027 will be held in Mumbai and Vadodara from Feb. 14 to 28.

Top six outfits

Mumbai’s Cricket Club of India (CCI) and the Vadodara International Cricket Stadium will be the venues for the tournament which will bring together six of

the world’s top sides – Australia, England, India, New Zealand, South Africa and Sri Lanka. The teams, which qualified as per their ICC T20I rankings on the July 6 qualification cut-off date, will play in a round-robin league. The top two will progress to the final on February 28.

“With a marquee ICC women’s event now taking place every year, we have an opportunity to build greater momentum for the women’s game,” said Jay Shah, ICC chairman.

From the Wall to the Hall

Once a boy who broke racquets and scrubbed toilets for it, Federer turned a hot temper into quiet grace and routine brilliance into religion, becoming tennis' closest thing to a spiritual experience. In Newport on Sunday, the Hall of Fame simply made it scripture

Anirudh Velamuri

There should be a word for what Roger Federer did on a tennis court, because “played” barely covers it. Watching him felt like being granted a glimpse of the divine, and that’s no exaggeration. Your jaw went slack, your eyes bulged, and sounds escaped your body that no grown adult should make over a man hitting a felt ball with a string racquet.

Federer did not invent anything. Every shot in his arsenal had been struck before, by someone else in some other era.

Yet, in his hands, the borrowed became the sacred, the familiar became revelation, as if the shot had been waiting its whole life for him specifically to unlock it. And he didn’t do it once in some career-defining flash of magic. He did it for the better part of two decades. It was a residency in genius, not a hot streak. Pete Sampras once said Federer’s game had no weaknesses, and it stands true. What other players built entire careers on – a single jaw-dropping moment etched into a highlight reel – Federer treated as routine.

Except, of course, that routine came around roughly a thousand times, spread across four Grand Slams and every corner of the world, and it never once stopped feeling like the first time. That is the strange arithmetic of Federer’s greatness: repetition should have dulled the wonder, but it never did. Familiarity, in his case, only sharpened the awe.

Now the residency has its plaque. The felt ball has been put down, the sermons have ended, and what’s left is the reckoning every great career eventually meets – not a match, but a monument.

On Sunday, the world celebrated Federer once again as he was inducted into the International Tennis Hall of Fame. It is the sport’s great farewell and its eternal afterlife in the same breath, a place where a player’s brilliance is carved into permanence, even as it reminds them that greatness is never solitary.

The crowd said as much. Billie Jean King, Martina Navratilova, Stefan Edberg, John McEnroe, Andy Roddick and many others were on hand to celebrate one of tennis’ finest champions.

And closer still sat the ones who needed no introduction. His parents, Robert and Lynette. His wife, Mirka, and his four kids that the tennis world had watched grow up, one Slam at a time, in players’ boxes scattered across the globe—.

Mirka spoke first and introduced her husband with a line that outshone every statistic that followed. “What makes me proudest isn’t what Roger accomplished when the world was watching. It’s who he is when nobody’s watching,” she said.

He, too, glowingly praised the one person who has seen the highs and lows of his stardom from a touch away, while also building a semblance of a normal life together.

“Mirka inspires me every day. She showed me how to stay focused on tennis and take joy in everything else. A wonderful mother to our four kids... she makes the impossible happen. We grab each other’s hands, and we run through walls.”

More than trophies

For once, the man who made the impossible look routine was undone by his own history. He tried, and failed, to hold it together – pausing a few times to wipe his eyes, half-laughing through his tears. At one point, he pleaded for tissues and sunglasses, but pressed on anyway, the way he always had.

When he steadied himself enough, he spoke not of the trophies or numerous records. He was more focused on the more than 5,000 headbands he wore, the more than 7,000 pairs of socks he went through, some 10,000 racquets strung over the years, and the thousands of sets played on the same two knees.

“I tried to show my love for the game. Because it really mattered to me, and I also wanted it to matter to you. To be worthy of your attention, worthy of your attendance, because people don’t have to come watch us play. They come to be entertained, inspired, excited. They could always decide to go somewhere else, but they chose tennis, they chose us,” he emphasised.

The 45-year-old even wandered back to where it all began, not in any packed



stadium but in the shadows just off it.

“I remember being a ball boy in Basel, standing against the back wall, hands behind me, eyes on the ball. I’ll never forget how the game looked from there... the intensity, the adversity, the feeling of being so close to the players. I remember the next morning, my legs were gone... standing all day is a lot of work.”

Federer, especially later in his career, had the power to make the smallest cog in the wheel seen and appreciated. His core memory helped him do the same once more at Newport.

“I really want to thank every ball kid who ever stood through my matches or all our matches, for that matter, for hours on end. I see you. I thank you. I was you.”

It’s a strange, fitting symmetry: that is precisely how everyone felt watching his career unfold. Standing still, eyes fixed on the ball, absorbing the intensity as though they were pressed against the back wall of the court – even from several hundred or several thousand kilometres away, on the other side of the television screen.

More than a hundred titles in his cabinet, and yet Federer insisted the number was never the point.

“They call this the Hall of Fame... but fame was never the goal. My goal was to spend my life doing something I love, with people who love it as much as I do.”

And he did – relentlessly, joyfully, for the better part of his life. Federer didn’t just win; he took tennis to altitudes it hadn’t

reached before, wrote storylines the sport had never dared to script, and handed the world rivalries (with Rafael Nadal and Novak Djokovic) that will be studied and mythologised for generations.

Smashed racquet, softened man

There was a time when the future maestro was closer to a menace. As a boy in Basel, he didn’t play tennis so much as wage a war with it – swearing between points, smashing racquets and the whole kit and caboodle. At 16, he tore through a practice backdrop, understandably earning a week-long toilet-scrubbing sentence from his coach.

By his own admission, the unlearning took years and was no epiphany. The real turning point wasn’t a victory or defeat, but a tragedy – the death of his childhood coach Peter Carter in 2002, which recalibrated Federer for good.

Self-deprecation became an art form, just like most things would with Federer. The same man, on Sunday, would hold up two ageing knees to a crowd of legends and grin, saying, “Still got them, by the way. If I fall, please catch me.” The once hot-headed boy is now at ease with

laughing at himself, and became the most graceful man in tennis – on the court and off it. And he did it all with the same unhurried smile, even in the moments when the headband was fighting a losing battle against the sweat of another title run, even when his body was being pushed past what bodies are supposed to give.

“I’m still writing my love letter to tennis. My time as a player is done, but tennis will always stand at the intersection of everything I care most about... my family, our friendships, the past 40 years and the future we’re building. So this is not a goodbye,” he stated.

“We all leave the court eventually, but the sport keeps evolving. This boy from Basel thanks you... and I thank all of you for sharing the journey.”

It is the tennis world, though, that owes its thanks to Federer.

He carried the sport to spaces it had never been invited into before – into living rooms of people who couldn’t tell a forehand from a backhand, into the vocabulary of art critics and poets who had never once written about sport, into a kind of beauty that made the utilitarian business of winning feel almost secondary. He turned rivalry into reverence, opponents into co-authors, and a simple racquet into something closer to a paintbrush.

The ball boy became the main event. And the boy who once stood against the back wall, eyes fixed on the ball with hands behind his back, has finally taken his place among the very heroes he once watched from the shadows.

That, perhaps, is the only ending fitting enough: not a farewell, but a homecoming.

Career in numbers

1 The only male player to appear in seven consecutive Wimbledon finals (2003 to 2009)

8 Federer holds the record for most Wimbledon men’s singles titles

19 Grass was Federer’s most successful surface, where he won an Open Era record 19 titles (including a record 10 Halle Open titles)

20 Number of Grand Slam singles titles he won. He is the first man in history to reach the milestone

31 The number of Grand Slam finals reached (20-11 win-loss record)

56 His record win streak on hard courts (2005 ABN AMRO World Tennis Tournament in Rotterdam to the 2006 Dubai Duty Free Tennis Championships)

103 Number of career titles won

224 Career victories against top-10 opponents, with a 64.6 win percentage

237 Holds the record for most consecutive weeks as World No. 1 (February 2, 2004 to August 17, 2008)

310 Number of weeks spent as the top-ranked player in the world, second only to Djokovic (428)

1,526 The number of matches Federer played (won 1,251 and lost 275)

Moving towards a universal vaccine against pneumonia and meningitis

Scientists are looking for a universal pneumococcal vaccine that can target all the hundred or so forms of *Streptococcus pneumonia* bacteria, and prevent some undesirable outcomes created by existing vaccines that keep the threat of pneumococcal diseases alive in the human population

S. Swaminathan

There is a bacterium called *Streptococcus pneumoniae*. It comes in at least a hundred different forms, or serotypes, and lives in the tissue lining our nose and throat. *S. pneumoniae* is normally harmless. But when your body's immune system becomes weaker, for example when you have a viral fever, these bacteria may invade your lungs and cause pneumonia, your brain and spinal cord to cause meningitis, and your bloodstream to cause sepsis.

These diseases are called pneumococcal diseases, and fortunately, they can be prevented by vaccines. Each of these vaccines contains a unique sugary substance called a capsular polysaccharide, aimed at each serotype of *S. pneumoniae*. That is, they offer protection specific to each serotype.

And the current crop of pneumococcal vaccines protect against only a subset of the 100-odd serotypes. To increase coverage, scientists need to include additional serotype-specific capsular polysaccharides in the vaccine. And covering all the serotypes in a single shot would be extremely challenging, not to mention extremely expensive as well.

Sugary shot

Recently, a team of British scientists reported an important first step in this direction. They did two things: first, they switched the polysaccharide with proteins and, second, they adopted an approach called reverse vaccinology.

Basically, two kinds of pneumococcal vaccines are available today. One is a mix of purified capsular polysaccharides from multiple serotypes. Pneumovax 23 is an example. It does not work well in infants and offers short-lived protection.

To help boost the effects as well as the durability of the immune response, scientists have linked the polysaccharides to a carrier protein. Such vaccines are known as pneumococcal conjugate vaccines (PCVs). Typical examples include PCV10 and PCV14; the numerals denote the number of serotypes included.

When these vaccines target and eliminate some serotypes of *S. pneumoniae*, it also opens the door for other serotypes to mount an infection. These non-vaccine serotypes also face less biological competition for space and resources, so they multiply and eventually replace the vaccine-targeted serotypes, rendering the vaccines obsolete.

Second, many non-vaccine serotypes either possess antibiotic resistance genes or can acquire them from their resistant counterparts. This leads to the rise of both vaccine- and antibiotic-resistant serotypes.

Thus, scientists are looking for a universal pneumococcal vaccine that can target all serotypes and prevent these outcomes, which keep the threat of pneumonia, meningitis, and other pneumococcal diseases alive in the population.



The agar plate with red blood cells on the left shows a positive Staphylococcus infection and on the right shows a positive Streptococcus infection. NCI/UNSPASH

Reverse vaccinology starts from the germ's genome to identify proteins that can be included in vaccines. Scientists demonstrated an example of this in the recent COVID-19 pandemic: once the virus's genome was sequenced in early 2020, scientists around the world could analyse it and zero in on the spike-protein gene to make COVID-19 vaccines. The approach completely bypassed the need to culture the germs in large bioreactors and purify molecular components from them to make the vaccine.

The *S. pneumoniae* genome encodes more than 2,000 genes. Of them, around 1,300 are common across serotypes. The genomic data of more than 20,000 *S. pneumoniae* isolates across nearly a hundred serotypes are also available in the public domain.

The scientists deployed extensive computational analysis using an arsenal of bioinformatic tools to analyse these sequences.

They reasoned that the best candidate genes for creating their universal vaccine would need to encode for proteins with three attributes: (i) it must be located on the surface so that the immune system can easily access it; (ii) it must have low or no similarity to human proteins, so that the immune system does not attack the body's tissue, and (iii) it must be capable of eliciting a robust and durable anti-pneumococcal immunity.

The team shortlisted some candidates and further whittled the list down based on their predicted shapes and stability. From this, the team picked three

candidate genes. They were: zinc metalloprotease B (Z), pneumococcal adherence virulence factor A (P), and a protein which the scientists designated YfhO-like (Y) due to its similarity to another bacterial protein.

The team produced proteins Z, P, and Y in the laboratory and made an experimental vaccine by mixing them together. They also added two non-protein immune response boosters: a small piece of synthetic DNA called CpG and a sugary polymer called chitosan. They named this formulation ZPY-CpG-Ch.

Potent antibodies

To test whether the vaccine could elicit protective anti-pneumococcal antibodies, the scientists vaccinated laboratory mice. After some time, they exposed the mice to a lethal dose of *S. pneumoniae* serotype 1, which is known to be hypervirulent. Compared to unvaccinated mice, all of which succumbed to the lethal dose, vaccinated mice showed 80-100% survival.

Importantly, the scientists found that the level of protection offered by ZPY-CpG-Ch was comparable to that of PCV13.

The team also found that antibodies from the mice vaccinated with ZPY-CpG-Ch could help kill *S. pneumoniae* bacteria in a test tube. When injected into unvaccinated mice, the antibodies could also protect them against a lethal dose of serotype 1.

Third, ZPY-CpG-Ch fully protected

vaccinated mice exposed to lethal doses of two non-vaccine serotypes, 11A and 33F. It also offered 50% protection against a third non-vaccine serotype, called serotype 8.

In all mouse experiments, measures of the vaccine's protective effect based on the bacterial load in lungs and blood mirrored the rodents' survival rates. However, the ZPY-CpG-Ch vaccine did not reduce the load of pneumococcal bacteria in the upper respiratory passages of vaccinated mice. That is, despite being protected, vaccinated mice have the ability to still spread the infection to uninfected mice.

Worthy goal

Finally, the team also reported that vaccinating mice with ZPY-CpG-Ch stimulated a subset of immune cells that are implicated in pneumococcal immunity.

The results from this work are too preliminary for ZPY-CpG-Ch to be a universal pneumococcal vaccine. It has also been tested against a very small subset of serotypes, four to be precise. Vaccine data from laboratory mice also may not truly reflect the human situation.

Nevertheless, this work represents a baby step towards the worthy goal of developing a universal pneumococcal vaccine.

(S. Swaminathan is a retired professor of biology at BITS-Pilani, Hyderabad, and a former scientist at ICGEB, New Delhi. ssn225@gmail.com)



Scientist Akiko Takii collects samples from a young Asiatic black bear before releasing it back into the wild in Nagano, Japan, in July 2026. AFP

An alternative emerges to check Japan's bear troubles

Agence France-Presse

As a sensor sounded, scientist Akiko Takii hurried to a bear trap deep in the forests of Nagano in Japan, where rising attacks have brought fear and resulted in the culling of thousands of the animals. "It is a small bear, I think, about a year and a half old," Ms. Takii said as she peered at the 15-kilogramme Asiatic black bear thrashing in the cage. "It must have just parted from mum." Its mother was not around, and Ms. Takii took blood and fur samples after her co-researcher tranquilised the young female. The animal was too small to be tagged with a GPS tracker, so she was released.

The process of trapping, tagging, and releasing the animals is part of a pioneering management plan launched in 1995, as authorities realised the bear population was shrinking in the mountainous region in the centre of Japan's Honshu island. And it is becoming part of a model of coexistence in the region that some experts believe is an alternative to the dominant practice of culling the animals in an effort to prevent attacks. "By not killing too many of them, more bears survive to live out their expected lifespan. In that sense, a healthy bear population is being formed," Ms. Takii said of the process, which is paired with other methods intended to keep bears away from humans and monitor their movement.

Even before a cull guidance in Japan was expanded in April, large numbers of bears were being killed; however, several communities are embracing co-existence to prevent attacks

Another group in the area used specially trained Karelian Bear Dogs to scare bears away, and more than 3,000 kilometres of fencing was installed near farms, towns, and along rivers to prevent encounters. Bears who slip through are tranquilised, tagged, and set free far away. The programme has been credited with prompting both a recovery in bear numbers – although the animals are hard to count – and fewer encounters with humans.

There is little sympathy across much of Japan for healthy bear populations. Bears have killed six people nationwide since April 1, after a record 13 fatal attacks last fiscal year, according to the Environment Ministry. Sightings last year doubled the previous record and bears are increasingly entering the outskirts of towns and cities.

The causes are complex and, including variations in the availability of food like acorns, are potentially linked to climate change. The emptying out of rural areas due to depopulation and urbanisation is also leaving forests, farmland, and buffer zones less managed, said Shuichi Kitoh, a Tokyo University professor emeritus of environmental ethics. The government's response has focused largely on culling bears, expanding the process beyond animals in towns to those that wander into buffer zones on the outskirts. Even before the cull guidance was expanded in April, large numbers of bears were being killed – a record 14,000 last fiscal year, or almost 40 a day.

Ms. Takii argued Nagano's coexistence programme offered a different path.

While direct comparisons are difficult, some figures appear to show it has helped limit dangerous encounters. Annual sightings have remained broadly stable at around 1,400 in recent years, while some northern prefectures have recorded sharp increases. Last year, Nagano recorded 11 bear-related incidents, including one death, compared with 59 encounters and four deaths in Akita further north and five fatalities in Iwate.

THE SCIENCE QUIZ

It works — but we do not know how

Vasudevan Mukunth

QUESTION 1
The element X is one of the most effective mood stabilisers known, but after having been in use for decades, medical researchers still lack consensus about how exactly it works. Leading theories say it affects inositol signalling and inhibits the GSK-3 enzyme, but they haven't been able to explain all of X's effects. Name X.

QUESTION 2
The general form of _____ induce unconsciousness, amnesia, and immobility during surgery and have been used safely for over 150 years, yet scientists still lack a cohesive theory of how they work at the molecular level. Different forms of the drugs also seem to act through somewhat different molecular routes, yet succeed in inducing unconsciousness. Fill in the blank.

QUESTION 3
The BCS theory does a good job

of explaining conventional superconductivity. However, high-temperature superconductors that scientists found in compounds called Y in the 1980s still lack a complete and cogent theoretical explanation for how they superconduct. Name Y.

QUESTION #4
_____, a.k.a. Glucophage, is used worldwide as a first-line drug in the treatment of type II diabetes, yet scientists are still figuring out how it lowers blood glucose levels. Some leading ideas include the drug's effects on the gut microbiome and the mitochondrial complex I. Fill in the blank.

QUESTION #5
At sub-anesthetic doses, name the drug derived from phencyclidine — and which was used as surgical anesthesia during the Vietnam War — that can lift severe depression within hours, in dramatic contrast to the drugs called SSRIs. As with other therapies on this list, its full mechanism of action is still unclear.



Visual: Name the phenomenon depicted here as an aeroplane flies through coloured smoke. A complete analytical theory describing it is one of the Millennium Prize problems. NASA

Answers to August 27 quiz:
1. Businessman who drilled world's first commercial oil well – Ans: **Edwin Drake**
2. Substance yielded along with crude oil, used to be flared off – Ans: **Natural gas**
3. Components of hydraulic fracturing fluid – Ans: **Water and sand**
4. Valve systems that prevented uncontrolled gushing of oil – Ans: **Blowout preventers**
5. Machines called 'noddling donkeys' to mechanically lift oil – Ans: **Pump jacks**
Visual: **Paul Thomas Anderson directed There Will Be Blood**

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